

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra from the Great Heap of Jewels: The Dharma Exposition in One Hundred Thousand Verses, the Chapter on the Teaching of the Three Vows

Ārya-Mahāratnakūṭa-dharma-paryāya-śatasāhasrika-grantha-trisaṃvara-nirdeśa-parivarta
-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 45 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 45 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Ārya-Mahāratnakūṭa-dharma-paryāya-śatasāhasrika-grantha-trisaṃvara-nirdeśa-parivarta, and in Tibetan as part of the collection called the Noble Great Heap of Jewels, or Ratnakūṭa. This text is a chapter — specifically the section entitled "The Teaching on the Three Vows" — drawn from an enormous dharma-exposition said to span one hundred thousand verses, and it belongs to the celebrated Ratnakūṭa collection, one of the major groupings of Mahāyāna sūtras in the Kangyur. Set on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, the sūtra opens in the classic narrative frame of the Buddha dwelling amid a richly described assembly of human and non-human beings, before proceeding to expound the nature and observance of the three vows. As Toh 45 in the Kangyur, it sits within the Ratnakūṭa section of that canon, which gathers together some of the most influential Mahāyāna scriptural teachings on bodhisattva ethics, discipline, and the path to awakening.

In the language of India: Ārya-Mahāratnakūṭa-dharma-paryāya-śatasāhasrika-grantha-trisaṃvara-nirdeśa-parivarta-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Great Vehicle Sūtra from the Noble Great Heap of Jewels, the Dharma-exposition in one hundred thousand verses, being the chapter entitled "The Teaching on the Three Vows." First fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha. That mountain king, Vulture Peak, was lofty and rounded, vast in height and breadth as the sky, bearing the soil of every harvest, endowed with flowers, garlands, and incense of many varieties. Hosts of kinnaras and male kiṃnaras roamed freely there; it was a dwelling place of many kinds of yakṣas, rākṣasas, and flesh-eating spirits. Hosts of wild animals also roamed there, namely: lions, tigers, elephants, rhinoceroses, bears, brown bears, leopards, buffalo, spotted deer, rhinoceros-faced creatures, blue-maned

bulls, cattle, deer, foxes, and troops of monkeys.

And there on that mountain dwelt many hundreds and thousands of birds of many kinds, namely: the necu, the mountain mynah, the cuckoo, the śaṅkhaśīta, geese, cranes, peacocks, the ghughūta, the kaḍaka, the thiṇril, the beautiful swan, the gonmasreg, the edanuMākākadhenu, the dandha, the kadamruha, the mora, the ngurpa, the viravata, the supreme vajra-bird, the karaṇḍava, the white-necked goose, the kukuha, the wealth-guardian, the śāma, the śikhaṃśīla, the crow, the owl, the kagkava, the kurata, the vulture, the bāntāśāka, the tsatsakala, the golden bird, the olva, the hawk, the sharp-eyed hawk, the screech owl, the fiery-winged bird, the kapintaka, the paṇḍika, the tsatika, the navatsatika, the tsaśa, the tsakora, the fierce crow, the fattening mountain mynah, the katamaka, the katsarūtsaka, the kararūbeka, and other such assembled birds. And by the power of the Buddha, those beings were free from the harm of attachment, free from the harm of aversion and delusion, and they did not devour one another. They dwelt together, regarding one another as mother and father.

Furthermore, on that mountain king Vulture Peak, amid clusters of many hundreds and thousands of trees with dense branches and full foliage, there dwelt sages, and they were among the following trees: the thaṇ tree, the palāśa, the aśvattha, the pippalī tree, the lac tree, the harīta, the tree of āmalaka, the tree of śkyurura, the tree of barura, the sāla, the tāla, the nagtamala, the doṅka tree, the āmra, the jambu tree, the kham tree, the kapittha, the cypress tree, the seṇḍeṇ, the mātuluṅga, the Nepal peach tree, the stāraga tree, the tintuka, the kudzaka, the dhavaka, the dhavaka, the sarala, the ela, the kṣupa, the nyagrodha, the dṛḍhanīma, the abragō, the kampila, the palāśa, the niyama, the kākeriya, the nityapilodi, the white pog tree, the hard-sap pog tree, the kūṇśī tree, sandalwood, red sandalwood, the ubhata, the sakabidza, the gārdza, the vigārdza, the golden tree, the panasa, the grape tree, the śīṇbal tree, the pārikṣatra, and the hilāste — all these adorned with gods.

Furthermore, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, many varieties of flowers that grow from the ground spring up as follows: the atimukta, the campaka, the skyaner, the bārṣika, the flower of the snama, the drimchok, the yūthikā, the danuskari, the balla, the taraṇī, the gabataraṇī, the kaṃsaguṇa, the eye of the sheep flower, the hāriṇika, the madatalika, and the mañjubuspika — with all these many varied flowers the king of mountains, Vulture Peak, is filled and beautiful.

Furthermore, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, many varieties of flowers that grow from water spring up as follows: the utpala, the padma, the kumuda, the white lotus, the paṅkaniriṭika, the kaṅkaraka, and the great kaṅkaraka — with these and other water-born flowers the king of mountains, Vulture Peak, is made beautiful.

Furthermore, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, great clouds continuously and without interruption gather at midnight. First, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, a cloud-god's son proclaims the rain cloud, and then, for as long as it takes to milk a cow, gentle rain possessing the eight qualities falls in fine, soft drops, one after another, thoroughly saturating all the area surrounding the king of mountains, Vulture Peak. At dawn the cloud-god disperses and the sky becomes cloudless, and then a cool, gentle, soothing breeze rises up. By these means, the sentient beings dwelling on the king of mountains, Vulture Peak, are refreshed, soothed, and satisfied. It is just like this: consider a garland maker, or the apprentice of a garland maker, who has strung a garland and then sprinkles it with water — that garland becomes more beautiful than it was before. In the same way, on the king of mountains, Vulture Peak, great clouds continuously and without interruption gather at midnight. First, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, a cloud-god's son proclaims the rain cloud, and then for as long as it takes to milk a cow, gentle rain possessing the eight qualities falls in fine, soft drops, one after another. At the hour when the dawn twilight breaks in the east, the cloud-god disperses and the sky becomes cloudless.

Furthermore, on the king of mountains, Vulture Peak, tender grasses grow — soft to the touch, fragrant, blue-green and supple, curling to the right — like this: as the color of the feathers on a peacock's neck; like this: as the fragrance of the bāṛṣaka flower; like this: as the touch of kācalinda cloth. When the foot is placed down they spring up four finger-breadths; when the foot is lifted they spring back four finger-breadths. They are adorned with flowers, leaves, and fruit, never enough to look upon.

Furthermore, on that king of mountains, Vulture Peak, there are many streams, ponds, lakes, small lakes, and pools completely filled with cool water. From these grow blue lotuses, yellow lotuses, red lotuses, white lotuses, lebrgan lotuses, those of crystal color, those of fire color, and those of golden color — all great, as large as a chariot wheel. When cut, their fragrance rises in all four directions for the distance of a yojana.

On the summit of that king of mountains there is a great lotus throne — enduring and unyielding to others, with a base hard as vajra, surrounded on its edges by great vaiḍūrya, its petals spread wide and of stainless gold from the Jambū River, its pollen pure as the finest sandalwood —

with stamens of precious stone at its core, vast and wide as an ocean in its measure, seized upon utterly by countless lords of asuras, draped in manifold nets of precious jewels of a hundred thousand kinds, with rains of perfumed water poured from clouds by countless lords of nāgas, with silk unfurled and patterned at the mouth by countless lords of garuḍas, gazed upon with benevolent minds by countless lords of kinnaras (half-human celestial musicians), worshipped with prostrations and adorned with patterns by countless lords of great serpents, praised, extolled, and honored by countless lords of gandharvas (celestial musicians), upon whom countless lords of gods rained down clouds of flowers, garlands, incense, ointments, powders, robes, parasols, victory banners, and divine pennants, before whom countless lords of Brahmā bowed their heads to the ground in reverence and adorned it with patterns, by whom countless divine sons of the Pure Abode ranks joined their palms in salutation, by countless wheel-turning monarchs among human lords welcomed with the seven precious royal treasures, welcomed and saluted by countless gods of the ocean, illumined by the rays of countless star-bright precious jewels, made supremely beautiful by countless precious jewels purified by merit, their essence unstained — countless precious jewels of Vairocana's brilliance, dazzlingly resplendent — countless precious jewels of glorious splendor, their glory fully blazing forth, seemingly infinite in extent — countless precious jewels of varied treasury, standing firm by being well grasped — countless precious jewels bearing the victory banner of Jambudvīpa, arrayed so as to be unyielding to others — countless vajra-lion precious jewels, adorned extensively — countless precious jewels of solar essence, patterned in colors of every variety — countless inconceivable precious jewels, patterned with inexhaustible arrangement — countless wish-fulfilling precious jewels.

That great lotus had arisen from the root of virtue, the transcendent merit of the Tathāgatas; it was ripened by the intention of the bodhisattvas; it made itself directly knowable in all directions; it arose from phenomena that had become like illusion; it was born from actions that carry no foul odor; it was arrayed in the mode of the nature of reality free from afflictions; it pervaded all by the nature of reality that is like a dream; it was sealed by the nature of

reality free from active construction; it was endowed with non-attachment; it pervaded all directions with the dharmadhātu; and it accorded with the most excellent proclamations of the buddha-realm. Even in countless aeons one could not comprehend the bounds of that great lotus — its appearance, its qualities, its shape, its color, its arrangement.

Upon that great lotus the Blessed One was seated in cross-legged posture, together at one time with a great Saṅgha of eight thousand monks: the venerable Kauṇḍinya the All-Knowing, the venerable Aśvajit, the venerable Vāṣpa, the venerable Mahānāman, the venerable Bhadrīka, the venerable Yaśas, the venerable Pūrṇa, the venerable Vimāla, the venerable Gavāṃpati, the venerable Subāhu, the venerable Nāḍī-Kāśyapa, the venerable Nāḍī-Kāśyapa of the river, the venerable Gayā-Kāśyapa, the venerable Mahā-Kāśyapa, the venerable Kātyāyana, the venerable Śāradvatīputra, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the venerable Anuruddha, the venerable Subhūti, the venerable Nandika, the venerable Pūrṇa son of Maitrāyaṇī, the venerable Upananda, the venerable Rāhula,

the venerable Ānanda and all the other eight thousand monks — every one of them having fully realized the essential nature of truth, having made the ultimate limit directly manifest, having entered into the intrinsic nature of phenomena, having crossed the ocean of existence, moving within the domain of suchness as though within open sky, having cut the bonds of latent tendencies and underlying habitual imprints, unattached to place or support, ranging freely in peace like the sky, having severed hesitation, doubt, and uncertainty regarding the buddhas, having entered the path of aspiration toward the ocean of the buddhas' primordial wisdom, having entered for the benefit of all beings, acting as a spiritual friend without being asked, having entered into the protection of all sentient beings, having become a friend who never abandons any sentient being, having definitively emerged from the domain of the buddhas' teaching, having entered into the protection of the Tathāgatas' teaching, having made aspirational prayers to uphold the teaching of the buddhas entirely, directly approaching the arising of the Tathāgatas' lineage, those in whom the wisdom of omniscience had become fully manifest.

Together with Samantabhadra, the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, and eight thousand other bodhisattvas — among them bodhisattvas bearing the following names: the bodhisattva of the wisdom of the supreme gnosis, of the wisdom of the supreme jewel, of the knowledge of all languages, of unobstructed wisdom, of the wisdom of the supreme flower, of the wisdom of the supreme sun, of the

wisdom of the supreme moon, of the wisdom of the supreme unstained, of vajra wisdom, of dustless wisdom; the bodhisattva of the wisdom of luminous appearance; the bodhisattvas Banner of Light, Banner of Sumeru, Banner of Jewels, Banner of Non-attachment, Banner of Flowers, Stainless Banner, Banner of the Sun, Beauteous Banner, Dustless Banner, and Banner of Luminous Appearance; the bodhisattvas Splendor of the Earth, Splendor of Jewels, Great Splendor, Splendor of Vajra Wisdom, Stainless Splendor, Splendor of the Sun, Splendor of the Moon, Splendor of the Mountain of Merit, Splendor of Wisdom's Light, and the bodhisattva of All-Pervading Splendor; the bodhisattvas Essence of Space, Essence of the Lotus, Essence of Jewels, Essence of the Sun, Essence of Purified Qualities, Essence of the Ocean of Dharma, Essence of Luminous Appearance, Navel Essence, and the bodhisattva Essence of the Glory of the Lotus; the bodhisattvas Eye of the Sun, Eye of Purity, Stainless Eye, Eye of Non-attachment, All-Seeing Eye, Eye of Keen Wisdom, Vajra Eye, Jewel Eye, Eye of Space, and the bodhisattva of the All-Encompassing Eye; the bodhisattvas Divine Crown, Jewel Crown Illuminating the Dharmadhātu, Jewel Crown of the Essence of Awakening, Crown Illuminating the Directions, Crown of the Essence from Which All Buddhas Arise, Crown Exalted above All the World, Crown of All-Pervading Luminous Appearance, Crown That Cannot Be Overwhelmed, Crown Adorned with the Lion Throne of All the Tathāgatas, and the bodhisattva of the Crown of All-Pervading Luminous Appearance of the Dharmadhātu Like Open Sky; the bodhisattvas Topknot of Brahmā the Lord, Topknot of the Lord of Nāgas, Topknot of the Luminous Emanations of All the Buddhas, and Topknot of the Essence of Awakening —

Topknot of the Ocean-Expanse of All Aspirations, Jewel King; Topknot Proclaimed by the Precious Jewel of Liberation Through the Maṇḍala of Light of All the Tathāgatas; Topknot Adorned with the Precious Jewel of Awareness That Is Inseparable from All the Expanse of Open Sky; Topknot Enveloped in the Net of Precious Jewels of the Victory Banner Manifesting the Emanations of All the Tathāgatas; Topknot of the Melodious Sound of the Wheel of Dharma of All the Tathāgatas; and the bodhisattva known as Topknot of the Melodious Sound of the Wheel of All Three Times —

and the bodhisattvas Great Light, Stainless Light, Precious Light, Dustless Light, Starlight, Dharma Light, Light of Peace, Sunlight, and Light of Emanations; and the bodhisattva Divine Light; and the bodhisattvas Pinnacle of Merit, Pinnacle of Wisdom, Pinnacle of Dharma, Pinnacle of

Superknowledge, Pinnacle of Light, Pinnacle of Flowers, Pinnacle of Jewels, Pinnacle of Intelligence, Pinnacle of Brahmā, and the bodhisattva All-Pervading Luminous Pinnacle; and the bodhisattvas Voice of Brahmā, Voice of the Ocean, Voice That Resounds Across the Earth, Voice of the Lord of the World, Voice of the Lord of Mountains, Voice of the King Who Shakes All Lords of Mountains, Voice That Fills the Entire Dharmadhātu, Voice That Proclaims All Oceans of the Dharma, Voice That Utterly Vanquishes All the Maṇḍalas of Māra, Voice That Proclaims the Thunder of Great Compassion, and the bodhisattva Melodious Voice That Thoroughly Pacifies the Suffering of All Beings; and the bodhisattvas Supreme in Dharma, Supreme in Excellence, Supreme in Wisdom, Supreme as a Mount Meru of Merit, Supreme in Highest Qualities, Supreme in Renown, Supreme in All-Pervading Luminosity, Supreme in Great Loving-Kindness, Supreme in the Luminosity of Wisdom, and the bodhisattva Supreme in the Lineage of the Tathāgatas; and the bodhisattvas Splendor of Light, Splendor of the Highest Excellence, Splendor of Supreme Dharma, Splendor of Luminous Appearance, Splendor of Dharma, Splendor of the Moon, Splendor of Open Sky, Splendor of Jewels, Splendor of the Pinnacle, and the bodhisattva Splendor of Wisdom; and the bodhisattvas King, Lord of the Śāla Trees Supreme; King, Lord of Dharma Supreme; King, Lord of the Great Elephant Supreme; King, Lord of Brahmā Supreme; King, Lord of Mountains Supreme; King, Lord of Assemblies Supreme; King, Lord of the Gods Supreme; King, Lord of Peace Supreme; King, Lord of the Unmoved Supreme; King, Lord of the Foremost Garuḍa Supreme; and the bodhisattva King, Lord of Supreme Awakening; and the bodhisattvas Sound of Peace, Sound of Non-Attachment, Melodious Sound of the Earth, Melodious Sound of the Ocean, Melodious Sound of the Clouds, Sound of the Appearance of Dharma, Melodious Sound of Open Sky, and the bodhisattva Sound That Proclaims All Roots of Virtue, Sound That Urges Forth by the Power of Former Aspirations, and the bodhisattva Melodious Sound of All the Maṇḍalas of Māra; and the bodhisattvas Intelligence of the Mountain of Wisdom, Intelligence of Open Sky, Stainless Intelligence, Intelligence Without Attachment, Intelligence That Is Awake, Intelligence Illuminating the Three Times, Intelligence of Jewels, Vast Intelligence, and Intelligence of All-Pervading Luminosity —

— and the bodhisattva Intelligence Appearing in the Manner of the Dharmadhātu, along with all eight thousand bodhisattvas in their entirety —

all of them having emerged with certainty from the aspirational prayer of Samantabhadra's conduct; filling all buddha-fields with their all-pervading

activity and moving through them without obstruction; going directly before all Tathāgatas and thereby blessing their bodies into boundlessness; the maṇḍalas of their eyes purified and clear, perceiving through recognition all the countless emanation bodies of the buddhas; their movement toward the gateway of perfect and complete awakening of all Tathāgatas unbroken in its stream, proceeding in beings without measure; taking into themselves the illumination that knows the manner of all the oceans of Dharma, their radiance thus boundless; displaying inexhaustible qualities across endless aeons through their pure discriminating awarenesses (pratisaṃvid); their field of wisdom-activity so pure as to transcend the compass of space; manifesting bodily forms among beings precisely in accordance with their intentions, abiding nowhere; free from cataracts of vision through their complete knowledge of the sphere free from sentient beings; their wisdom like open sky, filling all the dharmadhātu with a net of light-rays; their minds utterly stilled and deeply pacified; possessed of an experiential domain that encompasses all classes of dhāraṇī; fearless before those who surpass others through meditative absorption; endowed with the ultimate eye that abides in the dharmadhātu; having attained the abiding in non-apprehension of all phenomena; ranging across a boundless ocean of wisdom; having arrived at the far shore of supreme primordial wisdom; having attained the Perfection of Wisdom; through the perfection of miraculous power having gone beyond all supreme destinies of beings; and possessing sole mastery over the highest meditative absorption.

Together with them, and in company with some five hundred nuns, were the following: the Great Lady Gautamī (Mahāprajāpatī, the foster mother of the Buddha), the nun Sukhā, the nun Utpalavarṇā, the nun Gautamī the Lean, and the nun Grasping Fame, mother of Rāhu — along with another five hundred nuns.

Together with some five hundred laymen were the following: the layman Splendid Virtue, Splendor of the Earth, Radiance of Wisdom, Renowned Splendor, Supreme Renowned Splendor, Good Intelligence, Glory of the Moon, Joyful Moon, Great Joy, Rāhu the Good, and Great Good — along with five hundred other laymen.

And together with some five hundred laywomen were the following: the laywoman Great Light, Good Light, Good Form, Body of Manifest Joy, the Virtuous One, Glorious Virtue, Moonlight, Crest Light, Glorious Light, and Good Eyes — along with five hundred other laywomen.

Likewise, surrounded and attended by gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (scent-eaters), asuras, garuḍas (sky-soaring eagles), kinnaras (half-human beings), and great mahoragas (great serpents), and with all of them facing him, the Blessed One taught the Dharma — namely, the chapter on the Dharma-gateway called the Teaching of the Three Vows — and fully and completely set it forth.

He set it forth fully as the domain of all Tathāgatas, the explicit proclamation of the conduct of bodhisattvas, the illumination of all maṇḍalas of the dharmadhātu, the revelation of the perfect gathering of all Dharma-maṇḍalas, the ornament that purifies all field-maṇḍalas, the dispersal of all challenges from opponents, the utter vanquishing of the enemy armies arrayed against Māra's disputes, the satisfaction of the entire realm of sentient beings, the illumination of the dense obscurity of the minds of all sentient beings, the comprehension of the intentions of all sentient beings exactly as they are, and the demonstration of turning the wheel of Dharma in accordance with the faculties of all sentient beings.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, placed his right knee on the ground, and, pressing his palms together in homage toward the Blessed One, addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, what Dharmas should those sentient beings who seek the Dharma of the buddhas, the powers of the buddhas, and the fearlessness of the buddhas properly take up and abide in? What are the Dharmas that will bring about their complete ripening? What are the Dharmas by means of which they will become irreversible from and attain unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening?"

When this had been said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Mahākāśyapa: "Kāśyapa, it is excellent, excellent, that you have thought to ask about such matters for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, and for the sake, benefit, and happiness of gods and humans. Therefore, Kāśyapa, listen well and hold it in mind — I shall explain." The venerable Mahākāśyapa and the entire assembled retinue then listened to the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke to them thus:

"Kāśyapa, those sentient beings who seek the primordial wisdom of the buddhas, the powers of the buddhas, and the fearlessness of the buddhas — such beings perceive no Dharma whatsoever as a basis upon which roots of

virtue could arise. Kāśyapa, all these bodhisattvas who seek unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening — however many there may be — if they regard the Dharma of the buddhas as something apart from conditioned phenomena and regard the Dharma of the buddhas as something apart from the unconditioned, or if they think to themselves 'I am directing my mind toward the Dharma of the buddhas and engaging with them through perception,' or if they cognize 'I am contemplating the Dharma of the buddhas,' then that cognition is a turning away from the Dharma of the buddhas, and they should not be called ones who have properly entered unsurpassable, perfect, complete awakening. And why is that? Because to direct one's mind toward the Dharma of the buddhas as such is precisely self-grasping. If one applies daily effort and exerts oneself at that, it is self-grasping — there is no separation from it. Whatever has not separated from it is thinking. Whatever thinks, whatever thinks with, and whatever is thought about — all of that is deterioration. Whatever deteriorates runs about. Whatever runs about roams everywhere. Whatever roams everywhere follows along. Whatever follows along cogitates. Whatever cogitates conceptualizes. Whatever conceptualizes proliferates. Whatever proliferates fully proliferates. Whatever fully proliferates pervades with proliferation. Whatever pervades with proliferation is not at peace. Whatever is not at peace inclines toward distraction. Whatever inclines toward distraction wanders. Whatever wanders is impoverished. Impoverished in what? Impoverished in happiness. What is that happiness? That in which there is no conceptual proliferation — that is happiness. Whatever is impoverished is defective. Whatever is defective approaches. Whatever approaches lies latent. Whatever lies latent connects. Whatever connects fully connects. Whatever fully connects proceeds to complete connection. Whatever proceeds to complete connection speaks confusedly. Whatever speaks confusedly laments. Whatever laments burns. Whatever burns deteriorates — and such a one is enmeshed in the net that is the domain of phenomena designated as pleasant and unpleasant."

In this there is nothing whatsoever that abides as a phenomenon; and yet, through the stream of perception, one is bound by perception, and being bound by perception, that stream of perception continues — hence one is said to be "bound by perception."

The abode of what has not arisen is the abode of attachment, the abode of anger, the abode of aversion, the abode of delusion. Through thought and discursive cognition directed at what is improper conceptual elaboration, one

does not swiftly attain the unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Kāśyapa, that being so, this is the abode of craving. Why is it called the abode of craving? Because that which is called craving has no reality whatsoever, and in this there is nothing whatsoever through which there could be a phenomenon of craving, nor anything upon which there could be a phenomenon of craving. Yet through cleaving to the notion of craving, one cleaves and creates a smear upon space. Whoever creates a smear upon space will find that smear there — smeared by self, smeared by sentient beings, smeared by virtue and non-virtue.

Kāśyapa, that being so, one who constructs conceptual elaboration through phenomena that do not exist is without substance. Whoever, in the face of what is without substance, holds a perception of substance — that one treats awakening as a substance. Whoever treats awakening as a substance holds a perception of self. Whoever holds a perception of self should not be called a bodhisattva. Why is one said to hold a perception of self? Because perception is not apprehended. Where perception is not apprehended, there is no one who holds a perception; hence one is said to hold a perception of self. Now this phrase "perception of self" is a term of convenience whose basis is not ultimately real. Nevertheless, the thorough perfection of sentient beings is the thorough perfection of awakening. And what is awakening? It is the thorough perfection of what has become like an illusion. And what has become like an illusion? Perceiving and speaking of a great sentient being, perceiving and speaking of a great living being. Whoever perceives and dwells in perception, that one dwells in non-perception and in the absence of perception. Whoever is in non-perception and dwells in the absence of perception — that one generates pride. Whoever generates pride runs throughout suffering and rushes headlong into suffering. Whoever runs throughout suffering and rushes headlong into suffering runs and remains in speech — so has the Tathāgata declared. Why is one said to run and remain in speech? Because of intense mental engagement. Wherever there is mental engagement, there is ego-grasping. Wherever there is ego-grasping, there is activity. Wherever there is activity, there is intense being. Wherever there is intense being, there is narration, elaboration, and dwelling — so the Tathāgata has declared. Therefore all phenomena arise from mental engagement.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: masses of clouds arising in the open sky above have not come from the east, nor from the south, nor from the west, nor from the north, nor from above, nor from below, nor from any cardinal

direction, nor from any intermediate direction. The Tathāgata, speaking truly, knows that the clouds have not come from the ten directions, and then, through the way of meaning, the way of reasoning, and the way of truth, he declares truly and exactly as it is: "the mass of clouds is without mass." Therefore, what is without mass is called "the mass of clouds." Why is it called "the mass of clouds"? By reason of the openness of space. And of what sort is that openness of space?

It is erroneously conceived, through the conjunction of various signs, as "the sign of rising." Yet in that there is absolutely nothing that makes it known as rising. Regard the mass of clouds as something that has arisen from the sign of rising. That which is the sign of rising is itself without sign. Whatever perceives rising as something utterly real is not the mass of clouds.

Kāśyapa, consider this example. A certain person says to another person these words: "Go over to that shadow and settle there." Then the person of wise character says: "I have no wish to go — I am right here." The first person says: "I am not speaking to you; I am speaking to this shadow." The other person says: "O man, whatever was said by that shadow — that is to say, a shadowless thing speaking." Kāśyapa, then consider by what means that person comprehends all the conventional expressions there are. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, the Tathāgata, knowing the nature of all phenomena, roars the lion's roar truly and fully to the assembly.

Kāśyapa, the Tathāgata abides with a perception of non-accordance regarding phenomena that, in his understanding, accord, and the perception of self that sentient beings hold is, for the Tathāgata, the ultimate. Why is that? Because the Tathāgata knows, and because of what the Tathāgata knows: whatever perception sentient beings have is itself without perception.

Now, there are some of childish character who, not understanding that subtle and noble expression about the shadow, contend against the Tathāgata. It is for this reason that he declared: "The world contends with me; I do not contend with the world." And what is meant by "the world"? The word "world" refers to the world of sentient beings. Why is it called the world of sentient beings? Because however the Tathāgata knows it, the world is exactly that — and therefore sentient beings are called "the world."

What ordinary childish persons know is utter destruction, complete and thorough deterioration. That is to say, this complete falling apart is what makes their conventional expressions intelligible. Why? Because those who

dwell in this world are headed for great disintegration. Those who dwell in this world are covetous. Those who are covetous are wrathful. Those who are wrathful are confused. Those who are confused are impure. Those who are impure are adversarial. Adversarial to whom? Adversarial to the Tathāgata and to the śrāvakas of the Tathāgata. Those who are adversarial cling. Those who cling grasp at particulars. Those who grasp at particulars seek existence. Those who seek existence are seekers. Those who are seekers search further. Those who search further are not of few desires. Those who are not of few desires are full of activity. Those who are full of activity have great desires. Those who have great desires foster attachment to the desire realm, foster attachment to the form realm, and foster attachment to the formless realm. Those who foster such attachment are attached. Those who are attached go with the current and go in the direction of the current. Those who go with the current and in the direction of the current go toward death. Those who go toward death do not go toward nirvāṇa. Those who do not go toward nirvāṇa go without going.

All those who go without going — all of them go to hell.

Kāśyapa, this being so, engage in conduct through auspicious connection; do not engage through anger and strife, and not through dissolution. Those who are not through dissolution do not conceptualize about the perception of self. Those who do not conceptualize about the perception of self make "I" and "mine" into something solid. They let defilement flow. Why is there something called "I"? Because, abiding in various perceptions through grasping at what is not true, they fabricate karma. Those who fabricate karma while abiding in various perceptions do so because they grasp at the self as "I." And why is there something called "mine"? Because, through covetousness, through the sense of "mine," and through desires, one becomes embroiled in frantic activity; one destroys the mass of moral discipline; one turns the mind toward harmful intentions toward others; one is overpowered by anger; one becomes prideful toward oneself; one appropriates bare grain as one's own; one takes, accumulates, and claims as close possession. Therefore there is something called "mine."

Those who make something into "mine" go wandering. Those who go wandering are deluded. Those who are deluded are full of hatred. Those who are full of hatred are harsh. Those who are harsh devour. Those who devour are scorched. Those who are scorched are completely seized by attachment — through desire and attachment one makes perception of woman, perception of

man, and perception of a living being into one's own possession. Therefore there is something called "mine."

Furthermore, in essential meaning, this is called "speaking disagreeably about oneself" — for one's own sake one behaves childishly. One becomes habituated to childish ways. Therefore there is something called "mine."

Kāśyapa, this being so, whoever claims awakening without having heard these teachings, or claims to engage in the conduct of a bodhisattva — that is a claim of conduct only in name. Kāśyapa, as for the conduct of a bodhisattva, there is no conduct whatsoever within it, and therefore it is called the conduct of a bodhisattva.

Kāśyapa, there is an opportunity for a bodhisattva's conduct to become perfectly complete, to become whole, to become gathered, to become pure, to become clarified, to become utterly purified, and to become utterly victorious. Such bodhisattvas also teach the Dharma — they treat those teachings like the sky and do not make those teachings into a burden. They teach the great Dharma to those who are reasonable, not to those who are unreasonable. To those endowed with good qualities, not to those who dwell in faults. To those who abide by proper conduct, not to those of wicked conduct. You must take up these teachings, but take them up in such a way that you do not become attached to the Dharma. Why? Because the Tathāgata speaks what is supreme — for the sake of those sentient beings who are worthy of being taken up, I shall answer that question with the supreme Dharma. And what is the supreme Dharma? It is that in which there is no perception of Dharma.

Kāśyapa, in this regard, a bodhisattva should first and foremost be endowed with moral discipline. One whose mind harbors regret will not commit the uninterrupted actions (Skt. ānantarya). One will not defame nuns. One will not mix with a household as though a demon. One will not take life. One will not take what is not given. One will not engage in sexual misconduct. One will not speak falsely. One will not speak divisively. One will not speak harshly. One will not speak idly.

One will not become covetous. One will not become malicious. One will not hold wrong views. One will not think to harm oneself. One will not think to harm others. One will not desire gatherings. One will not desire enjoyments. One will not speak to others of games and contests meant for winning, nor engage in them oneself. One will not consort with eunuchs. One will not frequent prostitutes. One will not frequent loose women. One will not frequent

young girls. One will not associate with fowlers. One will not associate with fishermen. One will not associate with hunters of wild game. One will not associate with slaughterers. One will not associate with outcasts. One will not consort with another man's wife. One will not seize or quarrel over what is in the hands of butchers. All of these are to be thoroughly abandoned, abandoned utterly, like dogs and outcasts.

Toward those who have been thus thoroughly abandoned, one will not give rise to even a single moment of a confused or deluded mind. In this way, dwelling in the aspect of loving-kindness, one thoroughly abandons twenty stations. What are the twenty? First, thoroughly abandoning women: one will not chat idly with anyone, not engage in intimate conversation with anyone, and when others speak, one will not answer back. One will not be disrespectful toward one's parents. One will not be disrespectful toward the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha. When the assembly of twenty is not complete, one will not teach the Dharma to a gathering of women — though if one happens to be residing in a place among men, one may teach the Dharma at that time. One will not go to every place whatsoever to attend fully ordained nuns. One will not answer questions posed by fully ordained nuns. One will not write letters for women. One will not give without being asked. One will not in any way treat as one's own an invitation made by a woman who is a relative. One will not remain even for a moment before a woman with a mind attached through desire in any form whatsoever. One will not go alone to a secluded place with her, and will not in any way speak of one's own personal affairs. One will not in any way comply when summoned by a fully ordained nun, and one will certainly not comply when the invitation is of a comfortable or healthy nature. If a loose woman summons one, one will not in any way accept in the absence of the Saṅgha. One will not in any way enter the rains-retreat quarters of fully ordained nuns. One will not in any way come under the authority of a fully ordained nun. If a fully ordained nun should call out, one will cross one's arms, bow one's head, and depart from that place. If, while one is seated teaching the Dharma, a fully ordained nun comes to prostrate at one's feet, one will cover one's face with both hands and remain seated, and she should not cause one to move one's feet. A noble person will not be bold of body, but will be bold of mind through one-pointed recollection. One will not give rise in any form whatsoever to a mind of desire toward all things. One will not give rise in any form whatsoever to a mind of anger. In this way one must hold firm the commitment made for the sake of omniscience itself, and upon

hearing these teachings one must diligently and earnestly strive to accomplish them.

Kāśyapa, any son or daughter of good family who has properly entered the bodhisattva vehicle, and who, upon hearing these teachings, does not earnestly and diligently strive to accomplish them — such a one will be unable to awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Why is that? Kāśyapa, it is because unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening is attained through diligence, and not without it. Kāśyapa, if one could attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening without diligence, then even rabbits and cats would awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Why is that? Kāśyapa, if those who lack diligence could attain unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, then even sounds would awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — for the mere utterance of the words "may they become buddhas" would cause immeasurable sentient beings to be of the lineage of those who will become buddhas. Kāśyapa, in this way, even those sentient beings who for a single day sincerely accomplish this conduct are rare. What then need be said of an aeon, or a hundred thousand aeons? Thus it is difficult to encounter the arising of blessed buddhas in the world.

Kāśyapa, consider this example. Among all the sentient beings of the great trichilocosm — the great world-system of a thousand million worlds — there is one single being who, after an aeon, or a hundred aeons, or a thousand aeons, or a hundred thousand million aeons, will become a buddha. That one speaks toward awakening, saying, "May they become buddhas, may they become buddhas!" and the other sentient beings take up the same refrain, saying "May they become a buddha, may they become a buddha!" From such enumeration, their inhalation and exhalation would cease before the stream of their verbal action were interrupted. Kāśyapa, even through merely such verbal action, it would not be easy to bring to full maturation even those who have first given rise to the mind of a bodhisattva — how much less to achieve perfect, complete awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment. That is simply not possible.

Kāśyapa, a time will come when I shall have passed completely into nirvāṇa and you too shall have passed completely into nirvāṇa, and when the gods have little delight, and upon hearing my praises many sentient beings will give rise to the mind of awakening, aspiring to unsurpassed, perfect, complete enlightenment. Among those, whichever monks give rise to the mind of

awakening will for the most part tend to abide in twenty kinds of conduct. What are the twenty? They will associate with nuns. They will eat impure food. They will crave the soft and agreeable food eaten with broth. They will eat food fully prepared by nuns.

Kāśyapa, just as at present a monk of great learning, whether dwelling in a forest hermitage or in a village, is one who properly gathers and abides in the Dharma — so too, Kāśyapa, at that time monks, whether dwelling in forest hermitages or in villages, will gather and abide in the Dharma together with nuns. In those monks, minds of attachment will arise very frequently, while minds directed toward the Dharma will be absent. In those nuns as well, minds of attachment will arise very frequently, while minds directed toward the Dharma will be extremely rare.

Kāśyapa, consider to what extent those who have obtained the very name of bodhisattva will take to the path leading to the great chasm of the lower destinies. Kāśyapa, at that time they will be drawn together by the characteristics of the Dharma, and upon seeing one another they will be utterly inflamed by attachment. They will communicate their intentions by pursing their lips. They will gather together, remain in close proximity,

and they will take possession of dwelling places. They will first bow down before a teacher. After that, they will send gifts of medicine. After that, they will address one another by name. After that, they will install one another in their homes. Or else they will show one another the main road, show one another their lodgings. Even when passing in or out, they will ask, "How are you?" They will speak of one another as intimate friends and sisters of the ink-brush. Through unceasing glances they will gather at one another's dwellings. Having gathered there, they will mingle in attachment. Having mingled in attachment, they will make an offering of themselves. Having done so, they will call that very act by its name — and yet those are the practices of those who do not live the holy life (brahmacarya). Whoever relies on what is not Dharma will be without awakening, will be without the higher realms, and will be far from nirvāṇa.

They will have abandoned the Tathāgata. They will have cast aside the Dharma. They will have schemed against the Saṅgha. Gathered in one place, they will indulge in thoughts of sensual desire. They will think thoughts of ill-will and thoughts of cruelty. The four divine abidings that are the path of the bodhisattva will be entirely absent from them. It will be just as now one

cultivates the divine abidings, but in that era there will be thoughts of desire, thoughts of ill-will, and thoughts of cruelty. Kāśyapa, in that era abiding will be done by those who are not noble persons, by thieves, and by deceivers.

Kāśyapa, consider to what extent transgressions of the precepts will occur in that era. Moreover, upon hearing sūtras such as these, they will revile them. Those who formerly dwelt in pure moral discipline, who gave generously, and who in faith generated the mind of unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — those very persons, upon later hearing sūtras such as these, will abandon them.

Kāśyapa, consider in that era just the bare sign and the bare mark of those who will abandon sūtras such as these upon hearing them. In relation to that, the learned ones who are pure in moral discipline and who uphold the Dharma should recognize and completely abandon monks of this kind, of the sort described in the words of the sūtras — for those have no delight in the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era some will display the conduct of a bodhisattva for the sake of self-promotion, and they will be without heedfulness. Having become heedless, they will proclaim themselves superior even to pure pratyekabuddhas and arhats. They are incorrigible; they fall into what is improper, and they go to ruin through wrong conduct.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era there will appear those who dwell in improper occupations and do no proper work. In that era they will, through the very utterance of the word "awakening," regard themselves as great beings and cling to that entirely.

Kāśyapa, thus in that era it will become a place of mere signs and marks.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era some will become supremely accomplished and supremely practiced in a pretense of the perfections. This too will in that era become a place of mere signs and marks.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era there will be those who develop extreme hatred for sūtras such as these that speak the truth just as it is, and who discard them utterly. They will form the perception that sūtras such as these represent wrong views. Those foolish persons will not discern that what is spoken here concerns degenerate moral conduct. Kāśyapa, in that era all the faults of the thief will become attached,

It is for this reason that they, not seeing anything to claim as their own among those, will, through contempt born of the thought "I have not disturbed the awakening of the buddhas," abandon the awakening of the buddhas.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era there will be those who do not follow after the Saṅgha. This too will in that era become a place of mere signs and marks.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era most will fail to requite what has been done for them and will become deceivers. How long will they remain deceivers? They will remain deceivers for as long as the Tathāgata might speak their praises. They will seek to accomplish food for themselves by returning and thoroughly deceiving with words.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, in that era most will fail to requite what has been done for them. They will not praise individual liberation. They will fail to guard the actions of speech. Because they fail to guard the actions of speech, they will fail to guard their conduct, and those who dwell in improper situations and abide in what is improper will teach the Dharma to others. In this way they will make no sustained great effort in this Dharma. In this way, great numbers will dwell together with women; they will have abandoned men and will enter temple buildings and, having entered those temples, will sit together and will expound fabricated discourses crafted to resemble the Buddha's word and nirvāṇa.

Kāśyapa, when the Dharma has been entirely defiled through five hundred defilements, and when those five hundred are exhausted, then I intend that the openings to conduct unworthy of a person are many for the individual who makes no vigorous effort. In that era, these will be followed in no small measure. They will become indistinguishable from laypeople in their moral discipline. Kāśyapa, in that era such things will arise.

Therefore, one who seeks the true meaning and wishes to fully seek awakening must not associate with nuns. One must not dwell in such a way. All forms of association must be abandoned in every respect, and one must remain unassociated. All worldly material goods must be abandoned in every respect, and one must practice the alms round. All craving for robes must be abandoned, and one must be content with robes retrieved from dust-heaps. Multi-storied dwellings and all canopied structures must be abandoned in every respect; one must depend on riverbanks and hillsides, on flat stones and at the foot of trees. All food for the sick, all medicines, and all requisites must be abandoned, and one must depend on whatever has been discarded and

thrown away. Recognizing all sentient beings as having been related to one as mother and father in former lives, one must abide in loving-kindness. Scolding, beating, and all forms of tormenting must be entirely abandoned, and one must be patient. The households of friends and associates and all households that offer invitations must be abandoned, and one must depend on those with whom one has karmic connections. One must not associate with laypeople. One must accord with the individual liberation that has been taught just as it was taught.

Kāśyapa, those who intend to act in discord with individual liberation are those who intend to act in discord with the powers and fearlessness of the buddhas. Those who intend to act in discord with the powers and fearlessness of the buddhas are those who intend to act in discord with the awakening of all the Blessed Ones, the buddhas of the past, future, and present. As a consequence of that karmic maturation, the suffering experienced in the hells by however many sentient beings there are throughout a great trichiliocosm would not equal even one hundredth part of the feeling of suffering they would experience — not one thousandth, not one hundred-thousandth, not one ten-millionth, not by any count, fraction, reckoning, analogy, or cause would it come close. The suffering and

discomfort of such a kind — wishing to abandon it entirely, one must abandon conduct of that kind on the part of those monks from a distance of even a thousand leagues. If even the sound of their recitation is to be abandoned completely, to say nothing of seeing them or hearing them — those too are to be abandoned entirely.

One single Dharma is to be cultivated constantly. And what is that one Dharma? It is that all phenomena have become devoid of inherent existence. When one has become like that oneself, one will come to possess patience with respect to the non-inherent-existence of all phenomena — and then one will not associate with those who are not like that, will not draw near to them, and will not pay them homage.

Moreover, two Dharmas are to be cultivated constantly. And what are those two? The first is to thoroughly seek out the nature of reality that is the non-inherent-existence of all phenomena; and the second is not to generate even the mind that does the seeking. How is one to seek thoroughly? One seeks in such a way that those two — the seeker and the sought — come to be without object of apprehension. Since there is no object of apprehension there,

one should not generate even a mind of non-apprehension, for that would be a wrong view. Rather, with a mind free from all three realms, one should follow in the conduct of a bodhisattva. With a mind free from all marks and signs, one should follow in the conduct of a bodhisattva. The conduct of a bodhisattva is precisely this: what has been taught at that time. Whoever hears these Dharmas of this kind and abandons through abandonment — those, having gladdened the Tathāgata Maitreya, will not displease him and will not cause him distress. And so they will declare aloud in words: "Ah, how wonderful — we are liberated from the snares of Māra! Ah, how wonderful — we are liberated from the causes leading to the lower realms! Ah, how blissful!"

Kāśyapa, whoever at that time hears these sūtras of this kind and does not become frightened, does not become alarmed, and does not tremble — and who also comes to see themselves reflected therein and in whom the mind of retention through dhāraṇī arises — all of these the Tathāgata knows. All of them are guardians of my Dharma.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: the sons of a householder who is wealthy, of great riches and great possessions — if they, while still in that home, were to see even a single clay water-jar that had belonged to their father, they would, the moment they saw it, generate the perception: "This is mine, this belongs to my father." Yet at some other time, when the father has died and the wealth has been exhausted, they would set those clay jars down by the side of the road, or place them wherever it was convenient. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, at that time, those monks who hear these sūtras of this kind will generate this kind of attention and perception in mind: "These sūtras were spoken by the Tathāgata — spoken with beauty, spoken in a pleasing way." But then there are those other monks who, upon hearing these sūtras of this kind, will reject them. The monks who uphold the Dharma will think to themselves, "These sūtras were spoken by the Tathāgata," while those who have been scorned and thoroughly despised will be few and brought low. In order to keep these sūtras hidden, those monks will set them aside day and night.

Kāśyapa, thus those who at that time guard the Tathāgata Maitreya and guard the city of my Dharma will be few. I see them right now. Therefore, their antidote is just this: they will come to give up great generosity entirely.

Now, when those sons of good family hear Dharma teachings such as these and diligently accomplish them just as they have undertaken to do, they will

obtain the supreme essence from the Tathāgata Maitreya (Loving-Kindness). And those sentient beings who dwell in the holy life and look upon things rightly will likewise come to guard this city of the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, I do not see even a single sentient being who has failed to please me. In the final five hundred years, it is impossible that those who hear sūtras such as these will reject them; they will accept them, uphold them, and read them. And as for those who now see me and attend upon me — in the final five hundred years they will receive sūtras such as these, accept them, and uphold them. What need is there for me to say "Excellent!" to them? For they themselves are endowed with the primordial wisdom of omniscience. They will recollect me with joy, saying: "Alas, alas! Śākyamuni, through his supreme beneficence, has bestowed benefit upon us." They will speak those very words.

Kāśyapa, therefore, train in this Dharma. If you train in it, whatever you wish and desire will not be hard to find.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One thus: Blessed One, what shall I seek? Blessed One, I have no hope. Blessed One, I have fallen away entirely from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. Blessed One, when the time comes that I am endowed with the primordial wisdom of omniscience, I shall be very glad. Blessed One, I regard unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening as something wondrous. Blessed One, I find unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening difficult to attain.

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One addressed the venerable Mahākāśyapa in these words: Kāśyapa, I do not say this to you personally, but rather: if it were said with you as the reference point, that there is no doubt that they will swiftly and fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening — it is in regard to this very certainty that you harbor doubt. Kāśyapa, moreover, all those sentient beings who are possessed of thirst for the Dharma and who are possessed of thorough seeking for the Dharma will ultimately, after fully awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, teach the Dharma so that all seeking turns in the right direction.

The chapter called "The Teaching of the Three Vows," a sūtra of the Great Vehicle. Second fascicle.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva should be endowed with four qualities. What are the four? A bodhisattva should arouse diligence. And what is meant by diligence,

diligence? It is this: not seeking form, not seeking feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness — but seeking the undefiled phenomena (Skt. anāsrava-dharmas). What then are those undefiled phenomena? They are: the absence of the earth element, the absence of any discourse about the earth element, the absence of the water element, the absence of the fire element, the absence of the wind element, the absence of any discourse about the wind element — for whatever is discoursed about is merely imputed, and all those imputed phenomena are not real. Therefore, the bodhisattva should take up the essence that is free from imputation.

A question was posed: Blessed One, if imputed phenomena are not real, then when someone says, "If imputed phenomena are not real —"

"— does it not then follow that the imputation which is the utterance of the word 'buddha' is also not real?" — and, having asked this, he continued: "Blessed One, what am I to say in such a case? I have no wish to disparage the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha."

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Mahākāśyapa:

"Kāśyapa, in times to come there will appear monks who have not cultivated the body, who have not cultivated the mind, who have not cultivated moral discipline, and who have not cultivated wisdom. These will be beings who do not understand the meaning, who are given to belittling others, who are bold in harboring ill will, and who are bold in speech. They will not take up sūtras such as these, will not fully master them, will not hold them, and will not recite them. Why so? Because they conceive that form, feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness arise in fact. Indeed, sūtras such as these are teachings that deal in imputation. Those who arise at that time will dwell just as form arises, just as feeling arises, just as perception arises, just as formations arise, just as consciousness arises — in precisely that way will those monks abide in that age. And of what ultimate use are those who at that time arise as lay people or as certain monks? Kāśyapa, consider this example: if a golden garland is placed on a man who is blind from birth, he does not see it. Just so, Kāśyapa, in that age, even if those monks hear sūtras such as these, they will not be able to hold them even by way of verbal utterance — let alone by engaging with them through attending to the ultimate meaning. Kāśyapa, consider this further example: if a monkey is frightened by someone, for as long as it hears that person's name spoken it will be terrified and tremble with

fear. Just so, Kāśyapa, in that age, when those monks are rightly and properly urged by sūtras such as these, knowing that their own praise is not to be found therein and recognizing that they are themselves clothed in the robe of Dharma, they will become terrified and will tremble with fear. Kāśyapa, consider yet another example: if a monkey is tied near a cat, it will not face it and cannot bear to look at it. Just so, Kāśyapa, in that age, when monks hear sūtras such as these, they will turn their backs and will not face them. Kāśyapa, consider this further example: a fox flees from a dog and runs off into a charnel ground, into a hole, into a burrow. Just so, Kāśyapa, in that age, when those monks hear sūtras such as these, they will run with the running of a fox. Now the running of a fox is this: those who become corrupt in their moral discipline — upon hearing sūtras such as these they will abandon them. Kāśyapa, consider this: a fox runs into a charnel ground. Just so, Kāśyapa, in that age those monks too, upon hearing sūtras such as these, will run toward the household life, will run toward sensual pleasures, will run toward women, will run toward quarreling and slander, will run toward crowds, will run toward the language of remedies and medicines, will enter into the service of kings and dwell there, and those among them will become utterly corrupt in their moral discipline. That is what is called their going to a charnel ground. Kāśyapa, consider further: the fox runs into a hole."

Kāśyapa, just so, in that age those monks too, when the time of their death arrives, will plunge into the lower realms. That is what is called their running into a hole. Kāśyapa, consider further: the fox runs into a hole. Kāśyapa, just so, in that age those monks too will run and roam about through the great hells of the forest of sword-blades and through the great hells of the forest of bright trees. That is what is called their following the way of the fox.

Kāśyapa, a monk who possesses the qualities of a fox will be incapable of grasping or understanding sūtras such as these. What he will be capable of is reviling and rejecting them, and then, when his body breaks apart and he dies, falling into the lower realms, the wretched destinies, the downward fall — falling into the hells.

Kāśyapa, if there is a monk who says of this Dharma, which is correctly designated, that whatever is called "Tathāgata" is also merely a designation — that it is not correct — then the wise monks should say to him: "Venerable one, is it emptiness, or is it a designation? By what ground do you make this statement? State your ground." If he says, "It is a designation," then one should say to him: "In that case, you too will become a buddha. Why? Because

your name is also a designation." If he says, "It is emptiness," then one should say to him: "In that case, do not make any statement at all. Why? Because emptiness is inexpressible — it is emptiness that has been designated. That which is empty of self, empty of what belongs to a self, empty of sentient beings — that should be called empty." And one should then ask that monk: "Venerable monk, do you hold that all phenomena are empty?" If he says, "I do not accept emptiness," then one should say to him: "Venerable one, you have long since fallen away from the sons of Śākya, the śramaṇas. Why? Because the Blessed One taught emptiness — he did not teach it as self, did not teach it as sentient being, did not teach it as life-force, did not teach it as person." If he says, "All phenomena are empty, and I do accept emptiness," then one should say to him: "Venerable one, if all phenomena are empty, what need is there to speak of a Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha? Venerable one, is the eye the Tathāgata? Are the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind the Tathāgata?" If he says, "The eye is the Tathāgata; the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind are the Tathāgata," then one should say to him: "In that case, venerable one, you too are the Tathāgata." If he says, "The eye is not the Tathāgata, and through to the mind — none of these is the Tathāgata," then one should say to him: "In that case, the eye is a designation and is not the Tathāgata; through to the mind — each is a designation and none is the Tathāgata. Venerable one, since that is so, when you say 'the Tathāgata is not a designation,' what is it that we have failed to attain in that position?" If he says, "The eye is not the Tathāgata, nor is the Tathāgata something other than the eye; through to the mind — the mind is not the Tathāgata, nor is the Tathāgata something other than the mind," then one should say to him: "The Tathāgata has taught the twelve sense bases, namely: the sense base of the eye,

through to the sense base of the mind and the sense base of phenomena. Venerable one, since those very things are merely sentient beings or designations for sentient beings, is the eye the Tathāgata? Is everything through to the mind the Tathāgata?" If he then says, "The eye is the Tathāgata, and everything through to the mind is the Tathāgata," one should say to him: "In that case, all sentient beings would also be buddhas, and all the earth, all the mountains, all the trees, and everything contained in existence would become buddhas." If he says, "The eye is not the Tathāgata, and everything through to the mind is not the Tathāgata," one should say to him: "Then these are what the Tathāgata has taught as phenomena and

non-phenomena."

If he says, "Form is not the Tathāgata, and everything through to phenomena is not the Tathāgata," one should say to him: "Venerable one, is the Tathāgata then what is not a phenomenon?" If he says, "What is not a phenomenon is the Tathāgata," one should say to him: "In that case, all those sentient beings who do not grasp at a higher realm, who do not grasp at a lower realm, who do not grasp at the state of an ascetic (śramaṇa), who do not grasp at the state of a brahmin, who do not maintain the foremost of their lineage, who take life, who take what is not given, who engage in sexual misconduct through desire, who speak falsely, who engage in divisive speech, who speak harshly, who speak meaninglessly, who harbor covetousness, who possess minds of ill will, who hold wrong views — all of these beings in existence would also become Tathāgatas." If he says, "What is not a phenomenon is not the Tathāgata," one should say to him: "Therefore the Tathāgata is neither a phenomenon nor a non-phenomenon. That which is neither a phenomenon nor a non-phenomenon admits of no designation. Venerable one, given that, can one truly say 'the Tathāgata is not a designation'?" These words should be spoken to him.

Kāśyapa, those foolish persons should be refuted at every occasion through reasoning consistent with the Dharma. Kāśyapa, whoever is able to respond in a manner consistent with the Dharma to this settled, Dharma-consistent position — such a one I have not seen in the world with its gods, its māras, or its Brahmās, save for those who, in a contrary spirit, with anger, aversion, delusion, impatience, and groundless objection, will revile the emptiness of phenomena and go their way.

Kāśyapa, therefore you should uphold these sūtras of this kind. Kāśyapa, there will come a time when monks will refuse to uphold sūtras of this kind, and at that time three designations will be applied to them. What are the three? They are these: nihilistic speech, denial of things, denial of the aggregates, and denial of ritual observances.

Kāśyapa, at that time, people will abandon sūtras of this kind. Kāśyapa, at that time they will show no respect for the Tathāgata and no respect for the Dharma. Having shown no respect for the Tathāgata and the Dharma, consider what remains: they will be left with the mere title of a Saṅgha. Those will rely on mere designations, rely on mere names. Though they speak the names of the Buddha and the Dharma and teach others, they will not understand how

the Buddha is to be regarded.

They will speak the words "Buddha" and "Dharma," yet they will not come to understand what the Tathāgata taught as Dharma. They will speak of the four pairs of persons and the eight individual persons, and they will know nothing more than the mere names of the Blessed One's śrāvakas — they will not comprehend the qualities by which those names and their meanings are to be known; they will not understand those meanings at all. They will abandon the Dharma for the sake of clothing and food, for bedding, for medicine when ill, for material requisites.

Therefore, a bodhisattva should make diligent effort to thoroughly internalize sūtras such as these, enter into them personally, and hold them fast. And why is that? Because in a later time, those bodhisattvas will be the ones who guard the city of the Dharma.

Through teaching the Dharma in this way, ninety-one thousand aeons passed in emptiness. I know through direct knowledge that in times gone by, in each span of a thousand aeons, one Tathāgata arose in the world. I know through direct knowledge that in a past age, a Tathāgata named "Endowed with Peace" fully ripened bodhisattvas and remained for eighty-four thousand aeons for the benefit of the world. I know through direct knowledge that in a past age, a Tathāgata named "Stainless" remained for twenty million aeons, and having practiced the conduct of a bodhisattva for twenty million aeons, he then fully and perfectly awakened to the unsurpassable, complete, and perfect awakening.

Kāśyapa, consider how much hardship that Tathāgata undertook in order to bring benefit to sentient beings. Kāśyapa, even at such a time as this — the exhaustion of such a degenerate age — I will not speak in disparagement. Kāśyapa, it is a very great marvel that even a single sentient being, knowing my Dharma, yet with a staff in one hand and a weapon in the other, might think to come running toward me as an enemy. And why is that? Kāśyapa, the Dharma of noble persons is this: it is difficult to understand that one does not cling to all conditioned things whatsoever.

To view things as a self, or as a sentient being, or as a life-force, or as a person, or as arising, or to rely fundamentally upon the aggregates, or to view things as moral discipline, or to view things as the Buddha, or as the Dharma, or as the Saṅgha, or to view things as nirvāṇa — all those who hold any such view of nirvāṇa are known by the Tathāgata to be holding a wrong view. And

why is that? Kāśyapa, because the Tathāgata does not attend to nirvāṇa, and does not apprehend nirvāṇa as an object. Kāśyapa, all those who think of nirvāṇa and who apprehend it as an object — all of these are known by the Tathāgata to hold a wrong view. Those who hold wrong views are called those who do not know. Those who do not know are called the foolish. Those who are foolish — what is the awakening of a buddha to them? For them, even birth in the higher realms is very far away.

Kāśyapa, in a future time, monks of twenty years standing, or forty years, or fifty, or sixty, or seventy, or eighty, or ninety, or a hundred years — overpowered by old age, adorned with monastic robes, with shaved heads, with deceitful bodies, aged, having fallen into senility, deluded, bent over, their dignity diminished, gone astray — will appear. At the time of their death, overpowered by desire for evil and dwelling intentionally in lax Dharma practices,

they will proclaim their realization through three means. What are the three? They are: demonstrating conduct in every situation, laying claim to practice, or raising a finger. Through these three means they will proclaim their realization. Having fallen into overweening pride, at the time of their death they will die with a mind full of remorse. After their bodies perish and they die, they will be reborn in the wretched lower realms, in the evil destinies, in the downward fall, in the hells.

Therefore, Kāśyapa, you should be devoted to this and take it to heart. By all means, be a virtuous friend, one who desires the good of others, one who has compassion — and do not, like a wandering merchant who has roots and bonds, come to regret things afterward.

Kāśyapa, I do not give opportunity for going forth to those who hold a view of self, nor do I give it to those who hold a view of sentient being, nor to those who hold a view of life-force, nor to those who hold a view of person — I do not give the opportunity for going forth. Those to whom opportunity has not been given, if they go forth into this teaching, these thieves consume what is given in faith. They are not genuine monks possessed of ethical discipline. Kāśyapa, it is easy enough for a person to go six days without eating. But if someone goes forth into this teaching and then consumes what is given in faith while holding a view of self, a view of sentient being or life-force, a view of person, or a view that extends all the way to nirvāṇa — that is not the same.

In this regard, a bodhisattva should not come to hold a view of self, should not hold a view of sentient being, should not hold a view of life-force, should not hold a view of person, should not hold a view of arising, and should not hold a view of nirvāṇa. Striving to teach the Dharma for the purpose of abandoning all such views, one should apply joyous effort.

Kāśyapa, I have entrusted sūtras such as these to those noble beings of that kind. Why? Because those persons wish to become like me. Those who wish to become like me are to be guided by those who are like me. And those who are to be guided by us should in turn urge us on.

Then at that time the Blessed One declared these verses:

Those who are threatened by harm, by sentient beings,
without the protectors of the world who are free from conceptual elaboration
—

those beings have no refuge.

Among those who are low and have entered the wrong path,
those beings threatened by harm,
through whom the attachment that leads to lower destinies
arises and greatly increases —
they dwell utterly in a wilderness
without a guide, without a protector,
and fully enter upon a path
in which there is no ease.

It is like a merchant who sets out on a road
without bow and arrow:
a bandit overcomes and destroys him
and steals all his wealth —
wealth that came from suffering
has been consumed and wasted away,
and whatever things he has seized
bring him further harm in return.

Likewise here, some who have come to perform religious duties
have come having consumed that wealth,
the supreme virtue of former times.
Here they show their shaved heads,
falling under the power of childish views,
and come to hold perceptions of self and life-force

and equally of person.

Those monks who speak of emptiness
and do not rely on the person —
they generate a mind of hatred toward emptiness
and will quickly go to the lower realms.
They will commit acts of harm,
harming one another,
and slander what does not exist.

By that they will be put to shame. They will harm with body and harm with speech, and their minds will be possessed of great instability. Those who hold inverted views are utterly wicked in their course of existence. Having committed wicked deeds, they will quickly go to the lower realms. Harmed by sufferings, they will have no allies and no refuge.

In a future time, monks who are bold in harmful intent will arise, and they will harm those monks who have entered upon the path of awakening. Those of extreme and unbearable character will abandon sūtras such as this one, and they will not turn back toward or place faith in the teaching of Śākyamuni, the Lion of the Śākyas. They will harbor minds of great malice toward one another, and they will broadcast unpleasant words about each other in every direction. They will slander what does not exist, and by that they will be put to shame. The forces of evil companions will grow, and by that the power of the righteous will diminish. The power of the true Dharma having diminished, and the forces of the wicked having grown, those monks born from my heart, my sons, will set out. Thinking, "Where shall we go? Where shall we become virtuous? Where shall we be freed from these wicked ones?" — compassion will arise toward them on that account.

Therefore, at that time, they will keep this sūtra in mind. Let them know, with joy, the borderlands — the Protector of the World has declared this. "Come here! Go to that borderland praised by the buddhas!" When the time of utter ruin has come, the righteous will at that point be exceedingly rare.

Then some will say: "Where that great sage attained unsurpassed awakening — go there quickly, come!" And others will say: "This one has spoken well — the Protector of the World has declared that there are lands, causes, and fruits. The seat of awakening is beautiful. Going there is altogether easy. Those who oppress us here with minds of harm and would have us die — it is

not like that there." For my sake, those monks will wander through lands and will go to those places where buddhas have dwelt and dwelt, those supremely excellent abodes. And arriving there, they will gather together at the walking grounds, the sitting grounds, the stone slabs, the tree roots, and the empty places, and again and again they will weep.

"Here the great sage walked about in full. Yet one born in that time did not see that buddha. Here the great sage taught the sacred Dharma, proclaiming that all conditioned things are impermanent. Even that we have not seen today." Humans and non-humans, gods and nāgas, having assembled and being satisfied by his well-spoken words — even that we see as empty.

The supreme and sacred seat of awakening, Kṣitigarbha, is nearby the buddha's ground. Those monks will gather there and will reflect in the proper way. "Here the Protector of the World attained unsurpassed awakening. Here he caused the army of the wicked, like foxes, to be utterly terrified. Where the seat of the buddha is — this is the heart of the earth. Of those who have passed and of those who are yet to come, this is the seat of all." Right here, the great hero was honored by many hundreds of millions of gods. For seven days, in a single cross-legged posture, he gazed upon this tree. Having paid homage there as well, he will go on to where he grandly turned the wheel, where the world of Brahmā was reached, to teach the Dharma.

Those monks, having gone there, will again and again weep. "The hero came here, and at that time tamed the group of five." The group of five, having seen the buddha, felt discomfort in their minds, and the rule was established: "No one shall rise." The compassionate Teacher showed compassion toward living beings.

They will attain the deathless fruit,
instruction given to the community of five monks.
Paying homage to the wheel of Dharma,
again and again they will take time there,
and wherever the nirvāṇa occurred,
at the last they will wish to see the buddha.

For the benefit of all living beings,
it is here that the protector of the world
performed the division of the bones of his body.
Here the buddha passed into nirvāṇa,
the Śākya lion, the great sage.

"Alas, O buddha!" they will cry out.

"Your voice we have heard,
yet today we see you no more."

Here the great sage,
knowing in advance through primordial wisdom,
said of the last and most excellent monk:
"This one is the last."

Some will wander about and die.
Some will die dwelling well.
Some will die having gone on their wanderings.
Yet all of them will go to a happy destiny.

Then, in a later time,
those who abide excellently in moral discipline —
for them this teaching
will come to a great and complete cessation.

Those monks who are corrupt in their conduct
will all receive offerings.
Having consumed what was given in faith,
they will swiftly proceed to a lower destiny.

Even in that later time, those who are wise
will swiftly go to a happy destiny.
Whatever will arise in that age —
attend to the distinctions among the monks.

Then those who illumine the world,
those who are tenderhearted toward the world,
bodhisattvas of great wisdom,
those who benefit others with a mind of loving-kindness,
with minds of joy and gladness
will wait upon them and attend to them.

"Let us become buddhas.
Let us gladden Maitreya.
Before all living beings
let us honor the Teacher.
Just as we have aspired,
the Omniscient One will prophesy."

"On account of their great power,
I will explain for their sake.
As they behold face to face,
that buddha will look upon them.
I will breathe encouragement into these,
and I too shall become just like this."

Seeking all the branches of awakening,
they pay homage to all the buddhas.

Then the women too,
those who have entered upon the supreme awakening,
all of them will be encouraged.
Immeasurable Tathāgatas —
having abandoned the marks of womanhood,
they will swiftly come to be reborn as men.

Having seen the buddha Maitreya,
they will pay him homage.
Having aroused strong aspiration
and trained in the aids to knowledge,
all those who seek will find
without difficulty what they seek.

With strong aspiration, endowed with discipline,
and having become learned in the teachings,
at that time the buddha, the teacher of the grounds,
Maitreya, will prophesy concerning them.

Therefore, having heard this matter,
one should generate excellent faith.
For the benefit of all sentient beings
one should make the mind steadfast.

This place — why would a person who seeks it wholly fail to find it?
For one in whom wisdom and diligence are present,
awakening is not rare.

With a mind of joy and gladness,
one should not come with deceit.
One should cultivate a mind of loving-kindness
and dwell in solitary forest retreats.

This is the conduct of awakening.

Those who, by means of hoarding-dharmas,
speak of this place among others —
they are great fierce robbers,
and all sentient beings should bow before them. [Note: see note below.]

Those who, for the sake of food and drink,
gain and honor,
take up teachings to suit their own ends
and explain them to one another —
their life is not the highest,
their life is without purpose.
They will die in ruin,
and by that they will swiftly reach a lower state.

Through the door of the Dharma, some —
bestowing the name of monk on non-monks,
praising the prātimokṣa's fine words
yet speaking ill of the sūtras —
wherever their own discipline is fully perfect,
these have been declared by me:
monks who will be cast out by their form alone.

For them there is no passage to the good destinies. Whoever denigrates the world with its gods — however much denigration that may be — the one who denigrates the Teacher who is omniscient incurs even more than that. Therefore: restrain the body completely, restrain speech correctly, and do not harbor aversion in the mind. Then, at that time, pass into nirvāṇa.

Kāśyapa, when the Tathāgata has passed completely into nirvāṇa, and when the monks who rendered great service to the previous Victors have also passed completely into nirvāṇa, and when even those sentient beings of excellent and exalted aspiration have come to their time of death and been exhausted — a time will come when they are no more. In the final period of the last five hundred years of the holy Dharma, there will arise monks who are covetous, overcome by attachment, overwhelmed by excessive craving, given to slander, violent, arrogant, rough, and prone to anger. They will abide in three things. What are the three? They will abide in inferior trade and commerce, they will abide in buying and selling, and they will abide in

consorting and dwelling with women. They will come to abide in these three things.

They will fall away completely from four things. What are the four? They will fall away completely from the aggregate of moral discipline; they will fall away completely from going to the good destinies; they will fall away completely from the attainment of spiritual fruits; and they will fall away completely from seeing the buddhas just as they truly are. Those who are endowed with these four things — for them, four Dharma-factors that produce disillusionment will be exceedingly prevalent. What are the four? Envy will be exceedingly prevalent in them; anger will be exceedingly prevalent in them; excessive attachment to household life will be exceedingly prevalent in them; and, abandoning even themselves, they will place themselves, through covetousness, in the position of a vessel for things such as food. Attached to their Dharma-robles, overcome by craving, they will engage extensively in many basket-like Dharma activities. They will take up basket-like Dharma and abide in it. They will hoard and accumulate. The qualities of the renunciant will not remain in them.

Having heard teachings of this kind, they will seek, with still greater zeal, four kinds of dwelling. What are the four? They will seek with zeal the abandonment of the Dharma; they will speak what has not been permitted; they will teach the Dharma to assemblies composed of women alone; and, doing such things, they will seek with ever greater zeal to abandon the prātimokṣa. Having heard sūtras of this kind, they will commit acts that produce still greater poverty in the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, consider this example: if one were to smear bile on the nose of an already angry dog — Kāśyapa, what do you think? Would that dog become even more intensely angry? He replied: Blessed One, it would be so. The Blessed One declared: Kāśyapa, in just that way, those ignoble persons — like dogs, like demons — will arise. When monks who dwell on the foundation of the intention of the sūtra-school, who uphold teachings of this kind, who teach teachings of this kind, arrange matters with those people in the direction of modest desire, and cause them to speak in praise of modest desire, those people, upon hearing it, will become displeased. They will become despondent. They will become dispirited. They will become utterly tormented. Overcome by anger, they will say: "We have been placed in a time that is not our time, and a direction that is not our direction. Since we have been placed in a time that is not our time, we will pursue our own engagements and do

whatever we wish." They will reject sūtras of this kind upon hearing them, and they will come to know the anger of a sword's edge and a short spear.

Because they do not speak in praise of modest desire, they will say in so many words: "This was not taught by the Buddha." They are not of modest desire; rather, they cling to great desire.

Kāśyapa, I have taught the praise of modest desire in many ways — praise of pure livelihood, of contentment, of being easy to care for, of being easy to satisfy, of having few needs, of being cultivated in virtue, of being refined, of dwelling in solitude, and of being energetically diligent. Do not engage at length in dharmas that are like baskets of provisions. Why is that? Because these dharmas generate strength of heart — so do not be restless. Because these dharmas generate strength of heart — do not be fierce in anger. Do not take up possessions. Rid yourself of possessions. Do not entertain perceptions of signs. Make yourself unacquainted with having no refuge. Do not accumulate oxen and donkeys. Do not keep company with the dwelling places of laziness. Apply diligence to abandoning non-virtuous dharmas and accomplishing virtuous dharmas.

Kāśyapa, I have taught the praise of seclusion in many ways — praise of dwelling in solitude and of being without bustle and commotion. In this regard, those who dwell in the state of not having few needs, who are of great desire, who crave wrongdoing, who dwell in the way of not having few needs — these will reject and abandon those who dwell in this manner in the state of having few needs.

Kāśyapa, it is like this: For example, in the middle month of summer, a certain person, having drunk ghee and being by nature delirious from it, becomes thirsty and goes seeking water. He asks another person to bring him water. That person says: "Hey friend, you have drunk ghee — do not desire water! You will surely die!" But the first, overcome by anger, responds harshly and abusively toward that person, refusing to heed his words, and drinks the water anyway, coming to the hour of his death. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, monks will appear who are grasping in nature, craving things that are not virtue, dwelling in what is not virtue. When monks who hold to Dharma of this kind encourage them, saying "This is what should be done, this is what should not be done," those monks will be overcome by anger, will speak harshly, will be abusive, and will abandon sūtras of this kind, the Tathāgata's counsels and instructions.

Kāśyapa, therefore, even now, for the most part they quarrel with the Tathāgata himself. Kāśyapa, when the Tathāgata established the rules of training for the community of monks and praised eating in a single session, the monk Bhadrakṣema was overcome by anger and said: "Look: in three months you will come crawling to me." Kāśyapa, if such an occasion as this has arisen even in connection with this very highest essence of the pure life while the Tathāgata is still present — what need is there to speak of after the Tathāgata has passed into complete nirvāṇa? Monks who are attached to material things, attached to their begging bowls, attached to their robes, attached to medicinal supplies for the sick and to provisions; monks who are under the sway of torpor and sleep; monks who are bold in malice — if such monks, upon hearing sūtras of this kind, show no respect even for the Tathāgata, what need is there to speak of monks who are occupied with mundane affairs?

Kāśyapa, that this precious Dharma such as this should come to decline — that is wrong, utterly wrong. Therefore, sons and daughters of good family who desire what is beneficial, who have faith, in the time to come — the final age, the age of dregs, the age of utter concealment —

Sons of good family, in that time of famine, those who have heard such profound sūtras as these in my teaching should speak of them to those endowed with discernment, but not to those who lack discernment. They should speak of them to those who have faith, but not to those who lack faith. Kāśyapa, even now I speak to those endowed with discernment, but not to those who lack discernment. I speak to those who have faith, but not to those who lack faith.

Kāśyapa, a wild horse knows nothing of armor; and if armor were placed upon it, the horse would be unhappy with it — so what need is there to speak of its enduring the sound of conches, staffs with bells, great drums, and clay drums? That is simply impossible. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a monk of corrupt moral discipline will never be able to endure the Dharma of noble persons. Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: a wild horse will bolt in fright. Kāśyapa, in just the same way, a monk of corrupt moral discipline, if he hears even a single phrase — "all phenomena are selfless" — will become frightened, terrified, and contentious if he holds a perception of self. What then need be said of teaching him at close range? Rather, one should don armor and defeat hundreds of millions of the hordes of māra. One should defeat the opposing side without engaging in the most extreme quarreling. The armor to be worn for that purpose is rooted in the indestructible; rooted in the qualities of one

who is trained and possessed of the means of livelihood restrained; rooted in non-attachment; rooted in the absence of aversion; rooted in the absence of delusion; rooted in the absence of envy; rooted in the abandonment of desire; rooted in dwelling alone; and rooted in not sleeping. In every and all circumstances, one must not give rise to a mind of malice. In every and all circumstances, one must not give rise to a mind of attachment. One must not place hope in anything whatsoever. That armor is called "rooted in the absence of hope." Having donned such armor as this, one should arouse the mind of awakening, and one should be without any clinging to anything whatsoever.

One must not give rise to the perception of a self; one must not give rise to the perception of a sentient being; one must not give rise to the perception of a life force; one must not give rise to the perception of a person; one must not give rise to the perception of a woman; one must not give rise to the perception of a man; one must not give rise to the perception of the element of earth; one must not give rise to the perception of the element of water; one must not give rise to the perception of the element of fire; one must not give rise to the perception of the element of wind; one must not give rise to the perception of the desire realm; one must not give rise to the perception of the form realm; one must not give rise to the perception of the formless realm; one must not give rise to the perception of [proper] moral discipline; one must not give rise to the perception of corrupt moral discipline; and one must not give rise to the perception of emptiness. One must not give rise to any perception at all — for if one must not give rise even to the perception of nirvāṇa, what need is there to speak of giving rise to the perception of a self? Why should one not give rise to any perception? Because in this, that very perception is not apprehended at all.

Kāśyapa, if attachment were truly and ultimately real, one could not come to fully know its shifting and its cessation. Kāśyapa, attachment in this way is not apprehended as dwelling in an object or as residing in a direction — except in the speech of those who speak falsely. Therefore the Tathāgata speaks what is true and speaks in precise accordance with reality. Whatever attachment is, that is not a self; and those phenomena of such a kind are the phenomena of a renunciant. Those in which there is no apprehension — those are the phenomena of a renunciant. Those who grasp that perception will have grasped a perception of personhood equal in mass to Mount Meru, and they will have fallen away from this noble teaching.

They produced nothing of the phenomena of a renunciant; they did not abide in the phenomena of a renunciant, but took the gross and coarse as their burden. Therefore nothing whatsoever should be said to those men who are deluded, who have grown old in delusion. And why is that? It is because they have grasped at something; and by that grasping they will have seized upon the occasion for dwelling in the great hell of sentient beings for an unbearable eon.

Kāśyapa, look at the monk Kokālika, the monk Devadatta, the monk Khaṇḍadravya-Bya, the monk Katamorakatiśya, and the monk Sāgaradatta. Kāśyapa, look at the monk Aśvajit and Nābhaso. Kāśyapa, look also at the monk Suvarṇākṣa, who serves me, who walks and sits in my presence — look even at one who walks through the sky above by the power of miraculous ability — look even at one who cuts down a thousand non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) in accordance with the Dharma — and yet who does not place faith in me and does not accord with even a single word. Whoever does not accord with even a single word will go to an evil destination. And yet one who says merely the words "The Buddha is genuine" — even that person should be scattered and thoroughly dispersed with a heap of sandalwood splinters as large as Mount Meru. A canopy the size of a great trichiliocosm should be held aloft in the sky above. And why? Kāśyapa, if it is already difficult to place trust in the genuine sound of the Buddha, then what need is there to speak of one who, having placed faith and gone forth through that faith, abandons the qualities and pleasures of desire and practices meditative concentration, not abiding in anything at all?

Kāśyapa, those sentient beings who bear with this and train in the training as it has been established, and who also comprehend this nectar of the Dharma — they are supremely wonderful.

Kāśyapa, consider this example: in the midst of a great gathering, a drum made of hide has sounded and come forth victoriously — well made, producing sound just as it is struck, giving what is given, resplendent — and a certain person, having balanced it on his head without letting it fall, declares "I have accomplished something great!" and carries it away wrapped in cloths. But Kāśyapa, on looking, one sees that nothing whatsoever has been given by the drum, that it does not even exist, and so one discards it. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, one does not see anything whatsoever given by the glory of the Tathāgata, and seeing that it does not exist, one will discard it.

Kāśyapa, from the perception of self, attachment arises. From the perception of other, attachment arises. Kāśyapa, whoever fully knows the perception of self — that person, Kāśyapa, upon hearing sūtras such as these, will not be agitated. And why? Because agitation arises from discord. Therefore, upon hearing teachings such as these, one will gain a mind of renunciation even more profoundly than before. Those who grasp tightly are holders of wrong views. Those who hold wrong views, when urged on by something genuine like this, are agitated. And why? Kāśyapa, because the perception of self is what causes agitation.

Kāśyapa, any monk, nun, layman, or laywoman who, upon hearing teachings such as these, becomes agitated, gives rise to harmful intent, or seeks to reject them — though they may be called a renunciant, they have abandoned the designation of renunciant. They are not my śrāvakas, nor am I their Teacher. And why? Kāśyapa, those who speak falsely are not my śrāvakas, and I am not the Teacher of those who speak falsely. And why is that?

Because the Tathāgata speaks truthfully, and because the Tathāgata declares that all phenomena are empty.

Kāśyapa, the Tathāgata destroys the power of the self, and contends against it. Whoever contends against the Tathāgata is to be called a māra. The Tathāgata does not confer ordination or full ordination upon those of the māra's faction.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy. Suppose someone were to say: "A wool-bearing bull, a great elephant, has been born from a crow's nest." Kāśyapa, what do you think — should one believe that person's words?

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, no indeed."

The Blessed One asked: "Kāśyapa, what do you think — is that fitting or unfitting?"

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, it is unfitting."

The Blessed One declared: "Even more so, those who are not noble persons — those who abide in the perception of self, in the perception of sentient being, in the perception of a life-principle, in the perception of a person, and in the perception of nirvāṇa — and who then say of me 'He is the Teacher': they are utterly unfitting."

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy. Suppose someone were to say: "A crow has been born from a peacock." Kāśyapa, what do you think — should one believe

that person's words?

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, no indeed."

The Blessed One asked: "Kāśyapa, what do you think — is that fitting or unfitting?"

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, it is unfitting."

The Blessed One declared: "Even more so, those who are not noble persons — those who abide in the perception of self and so on through to the perception of nirvāṇa — and who then say of me 'He is the Teacher': they are utterly unfitting."

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy. Suppose someone were to say: "A firefly has lifted up Mount Meru and carried it away." Kāśyapa, what do you think — should one believe that person's words?

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, no indeed."

The Blessed One asked: "Kāśyapa, what do you think — is that fitting or unfitting?"

Kāśyapa replied: "Blessed One, it is unfitting."

The Blessed One declared: "Even more so, those who are not noble persons — those who abide in the perception of self and so on through to the perception of nirvāṇa — and who then say of me 'He is the Teacher': they are utterly unfitting."

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy. Suppose there is a certain attendant of a king. A certain person who has never seen the king learns from that attendant, then goes to a royal dwelling, enters among the king's retinue, and says without hesitation: "The king has spoken thus. The king has issued commands of the following kind — do accordingly. I am a person who has not seen the king or his great ministers; I have come from a royal dwelling." He says such things and acts accordingly: "I shall go in place of the king or the king's great ministers even at the cost of my life." In the very same way, Kāśyapa, the Tathāgata too is endowed with complete powers and with the full accomplishment of his own activity. Just as a king might bring peace to a vast and boundless great realm and provisions of food would also arise therein, so too the Tathāgata brings peace to a boundless Saṅgha and to many buddha fields, and provisions of nourishment also arise therein.

As for that person who has never seen the king, who speaks of self —

those who speak of sentient beings down to those who speak of nirvāṇa — they come, and coming uninvited, they say: "The Tathāgata has declared this. The Tathāgata has declared such things as: 'This is to be done; this is not to be done.'" Among them, those who accord with his instructions and with the words of his guidance and teaching have genuine faith in the Tathāgata's word and do not contradict it. Having heard, they dedicate themselves along with their own persons, and they give together with their children and their wives. They give supremely well and with great refinement; they give with the utmost respect; they give with faith; and for as long as they have not fully understood, they continue to give with faith. Thus, those who are endowed with such qualities and such conduct resemble the man who had never seen the king. They spend their days and nights in the enjoyment of such company, speaking of the king, speaking of robbers, speaking of food, speaking of drink, speaking of courtesans, speaking of women, speaking disparagingly, speaking of a lunar eclipse and of a solar eclipse, saying "The king is coming," "The king is going," "The king is among the queen's retinue," and speaking of domestic matters. They say things like: "Let us go to where it is pleasant; let us go to where food is given." Spending a single day passing the time in this way, they then go to the temple. Having stayed two days, three days, four days, five days, or six days, they speak of their stay there and of such matters. Then, through the constant talk of various intoxicating drinks, their bodies become senseless, slobber drips from their mouths, they get drunk and lie down. Whatever they have done there, they dream about. They dream of going somewhere. They dream of accomplishing some quality they have not yet obtained. Waking up, they talk to one another: "You went like this in the night," "You were sitting like this," "You obtained that." To those who have not yet obtained it they say to one another, "Hurry up and get it quickly; go on, excellent!" Having dreamed those auspicious dreams, they enter into villages, towns, hamlets, districts, and the environs of royal palaces. Grinning at one another with dark and suffering faces, with the cause of being unsettled, with minds that are unsteady and scattered, laughing loudly with faculties dulled, distracted and unmindful in their conduct, they go from house to house, abandoning their own individual liberation, and they teach the Dharma to women who are dependent and close at hand. Thinking, "From them we shall obtain great gain," they practice the Dharma and obtain gain from them. Attached and clinging, they cast off restraint, becoming overcome and ever more attached. And having become ever more attached, they go about weeping without remorse. They demonstrate two places prominently — what are these two?

They are seen to praise what is very good and very peaceful, while some speak ill of what is not good at all. Let alone the donors! These too, having gathered together, look at one another and say: "What was given? Who gave it? How much was given? How much was spent?"

Kāśyapa, these are the categories of those who, until the time of death, do not strive in yoga practice. There is yet another thing to know about those who lack yoga practice: namely, that they abandon all Dharma. Kāśyapa, one should feel compassion for monks such as these. Why so? Because their karmic maturation will be one of suffering.

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these verses:

For the sake of making a living,
the childish are courted by kings.
They go from house to house,
saying, "The king has declared this."
Going thence, they spread slander,
and when angered, the king cuts off with punishment.
By such power of the childish
they ever make their livelihood.

One who for a hundred eons and more
gave away hands and feet entirely,
and performed many deeds difficult to do —
what need is there to speak of looking to a buddha?

"I am a man of the Dharma-king,
with power to impose severe punishment.
As for what to do and how to act,
there is no one I need ask."

They give dwellings to monks,
and the finest food and drink,
and the most excellent robes of Dharma —
all these they give with reverence.

"Even so, I myself shall not consume this,
nor shall I give it to my children;
having sought it with great toil and suffering,
I gave it to those who hold moral discipline."

Then whatever is improper among these things
is quickly put to use,
and gathering in one corner,
they cry out, "Who has had it good?"

Talk of kings and talk of thieves,
talk of places of sport and entertainment,
talk of food and talk of drink —
assembling together, they speak of all this.

Eclipses of the sun and moon by Rāhu,
the coming and going of kings,
who will be victorious there,
who will be defeated there —
these improper matters they recite
again and again.

Having made a bed with fine bedding,
they lie down deep in the night.
"This giving was poor in that regard;
that gift was not excellent."
Not finding it again and again,
they ponder where there is a good household to approach.

As long as they deliberate on their aim
and then lie down to sleep,
the improper, confused, and dull-minded —
like a donkey carrying a load —
dream whatever they had been pondering,
and upon waking recount it all,
speaking of it to one another.

"I will not obstruct you —
you have dreamed a good dream for yourself.
Without letting discomfort arise,
go quickly and accomplish that."

How very restrained they appear
as they go to towns and villages,
yet all with dark, grinning faces,
they wander about like monkeys.

Entering into households,
they eloquently expound the individual liberation teaching (prātimokṣa),
and setting aside the Buddha's sūtras,
they teach Dharma to women.

When leaving those households,
toward whoever gave little and poorly,
they revile both the donor
and that person's relatives and friends.

Again gathering together,
they ask one another:
"What did you get? What did you eat?
What were you asked?" — and so they speak.

Thus, as before, it continues:
year after year, for a hundred years,
with thoughts just like these
they make their living.

And then, having argued,
"This will be medicinal —
it will reduce illness,"
they collect the honey of flowers.

Having abandoned meditation,
they associate with householders.
For such as these, what would a buddha —
even a hundred buddhas — do?

Having renounced the notion of poverty regarding oneself
and constantly abandoned the self-perception,
those who will generate the yoga practice
by which one does not fall into lower states —
for such as these, that is supremely difficult.

Thus the childish and dull-minded,
who associate with householders,
abandon the sacred Dharma.

Those who are true śrāvakas dwelling in the proper domain of Śākyamuni, the
Lion of the Śākyas, cannot transgress the training even for the sake of their
lives. The wise one, who generates the perception of food as a burden, does

not crave food. Meditating on the unattractive with respect to it, one remains with it and purifies oneself. In order to abandon the defilements of desire, one destroys all ordinary perceptions. For those such as these, this teaching opens the door to going forth.

When one searches again and again and finds no essence therein, emptiness, which is declared as the absence of any core, is not disparaged by one who is learned in the Dharma. Those who are skilled in the way of emptiness are courageous and of great wisdom. They strike fear into Māra together with his armies. They practice generosity in each of those domains. They have no attachment. They do not contradict emptiness. Those brave ones, those sons of the buddhas, are among two-legged beings the very abode of giving.

When those of poor understanding become numerous, the sacred Dharma will abide but briefly. When a monk seeks with heedfulness, those of learning will become few. Death will come swiftly, and the wise should therefore generate weariness, thinking: "Day and night I will speak the true teaching about myself." Apart from the supreme among two-legged beings, there is no other refuge in the world. I will train in the trainings and make my dying time well.

Those who do not understand this teaching spoken with such intention show no respect even for the unsurpassable buddhas, nor for the Dharma. Alas, the sacred Dharma will be exhausted — these will not endure for long; the stream will not last, long or short. Therefore, apply yourselves to steadfast diligence.

Having thus declared this, the venerable Kāśyapa the Great addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is remarkable that those who hear such sūtras as this do not genuinely generate such weariness."

Having said this, the Blessed One spoke thus to the venerable Kāśyapa the Great: "Kāśyapa, sentient beings possessed of four qualities do not generate weariness. What are the four? Being greatly heedless; not believing in the karmic maturation of actions; not believing in the great hell realms for sentient beings; and not believing that they themselves will die. Kāśyapa, sentient beings possessed of those four qualities do not generate weariness.

"Kāśyapa, furthermore, sentient beings possessed of another four qualities do not generate weariness. What are the four? Being youthful in body and remaining without interruption in that state; being endowed with power and strength; being greatly attached to the objects of desire; and, being intent on magnificence, having never tasted meditative absorption and being possessed of the force of craving. Kāśyapa, sentient beings possessed of those four

qualities do not generate weariness.

"Kāśyapa, a monk possessed of four qualities abandons the awakening of a buddha. What are the four? He has previously committed sinful actions; he becomes impoverished in the Dharma; the karmic maturation of his non-virtuous deeds is displayed; and his preceptor and teacher are people praised by the multitude — following such a one and training in their ways, he abandons awakening, becomes learned but sparse in hearing, and out of jealousy regarding others' qualities envies them. Such a monk abandons the awakening of a buddha. Kāśyapa, a monk possessed of those four qualities abandons the awakening of a buddha."

This is the third and final fascicle of the chapter called "The Teaching on the Three Vows," a sūtra of the Great Vehicle.

Kāśyapa, there is one quality that makes one a contemplative and one quality that makes one a brahmin. What is that one quality?

Non-abiding of mind in all phenomena — that is the one quality that makes one a contemplative and makes one a brahmin.

Kāśyapa, consider this analogy: if a person were to fall from a cliff into a ravine and, perceiving emptiness in an open space, an empty place among trees, and the empty sky, were to realize the earth as empty — that person's breath would no longer flow inward and outward. In just the same way, Kāśyapa, grasping at all phenomena, grasping with the eye at a sign (nimitta) and grasping with the eye at a characteristic — that is not the quality that makes one a contemplative, and it is not the quality that makes one a brahmin. Likewise, grasping with the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, or the mind at a sign and grasping at a characteristic — that is not the quality that makes one a contemplative, and it is not the quality that makes one a brahmin. Grasping at a characteristic with respect to form, or grasping at a characteristic with respect to feeling, perception, formations, or consciousness — that is not the quality that makes one a contemplative, and it is not the quality that makes one a brahmin.

The following, too, are not the quality that makes one a contemplative, and not the quality that makes one a brahmin: claiming awakening on account of moral discipline and conceiving of awakening with pride on account of moral discipline; conceiving of awakening with pride through the thorough pursuit of learning; claiming awakening on account of moral shame and moral conscientiousness; conceiving of awakening with pride on account of coming

and going. Whatever quality involves conceiving with pride — that quality becomes a source of harm. How does it become a source of harm? It becomes a source of harm through attachment, through aversion, and through delusion.

In this regard, one who grasps with the eye at a characteristic will be harmed by forms that are agreeable and disagreeable, on account of that grasping at a characteristic. The same holds for the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind. If one grasps with the mind at a characteristic, one will be harmed by mental phenomena that are agreeable and disagreeable, on account of that grasping at a characteristic. Whoever is so harmed will fall into hell-beings, the realm of animals, the sphere of hungry ghosts, or the company of gods and humans in a state of deprivation. Whoever falls into deprivation will fall through conceit and pride.

Now, what is conceit and pride? Thinking "I am" is conceit. Thinking "this is mine" is conceit. Thinking "she is a woman" is conceit. Thinking "he is a man" is conceit. Thinking "it is earth" is conceit. Thinking "it is water" is conceit. Thinking "it is fire" is conceit. Thinking "it is wind" is conceit. Perceiving something as a skeleton is conceit. Perceiving something as eaten away is conceit. Perceiving something as discolored and livid is conceit. Perceiving something as reddened is conceit. Perceiving something as infested with worms is conceit. Perceiving something as wholly dissolved is conceit. Thinking "there exists some liberation of whatever kind" and thereby being proud with the thought "by means of that I shall become liberated" — that is conceit. Thinking "I shall first practice the recollection of previous abodes in their many forms" is conceit. Thinking "I shall recollect a self" is conceit. "It is thoroughly past." "It is occurring right now." "That which I, the self, am is past." "That which I, the self, am is occurring right now" — all such thoughts are conceit. Whatever one perceives as something or somewhere — that is conceit. Perceiving all the way to nirvāṇa is conceit. Thinking "I shall attain nirvāṇa" is conceit.

Kāśyapa, in brief, taking something as an object is conceit. Whatever perception one enters into — even perceiving it as emptiness, every last bit of that too is conceit, and it is not the quality that makes one a contemplative —

— and not the quality that makes one a brahmin. For all of these are conceit entirely. Thus, none of this is the conduct of a contemplative, nor the conduct of a brahmin. The qualities that make one a contemplative and a brahmin are those taught by the Tathāgata, Kāśyapa, and they are like the sky or like the

earth. Why? Because the sky does not think to itself, "I am the sky." In the same way, Kāśyapa, a contemplative and a brahmin too do not think, "I am a contemplative," or "I am a brahmin." Therefore, Kāśyapa, the quality that consists in not forming conceit regarding these phenomena is the quality that makes one a contemplative and the quality that makes one a brahmin. Why are they called the quality that makes one a contemplative and the quality that makes one a brahmin? Because for such a one there is neither doing nor not-doing — and therefore they are called the quality that makes one a contemplative and the quality that makes one a brahmin.

Kāśyapa, consider the following analogy. Suppose a certain person, having entered the darkness of night — utter, dense darkness — waves their arms and lifts their face and cries out like this to the world. When they cry out to the world, Kāśyapa, what do you think? Whom has that person cried out to? Kāśyapa replied: Blessed One, they have cried out to themselves. And why? Because there was no one there to cry out to. The Blessed One declared: In the same way, Kāśyapa, a monk (bhikṣu) — whether dwelling in a forest hermitage, at the foot of a tree, in an empty dwelling, or in the open air — who attends to the thought "the eye is impermanent," who attends to the thought "the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind are impermanent," who attends to the thought "form is impermanent," who attends to the thought "sound, smell, taste, touch, and mental phenomena are impermanent," and who attends to the thought "I shall attain nirvāṇa, I shall pacify myself" — such conduct as this is not the conduct of a contemplative. Why? Because one who takes the eye as an object and then strenuously applies effort and forms volitional activity in order to negate the eye is conceived to be grasping at wrongdoing. And one who takes the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind as objects and then strenuously applies effort and forms volitional activity in order to negate the mind — such a person, by means of attending to and striving for the three loci, entertains conceptual thought about the three loci. And where there is conceptual thought through seeing, how can there be single-pointedness of mind?

Kāśyapa, this awakening of a buddha is profound and difficult to realize. The accumulation is difficult to take up in practice. Kāśyapa, as for what is called single-pointedness of mind — to what degree is it called single-pointedness of mind? It is this: not apprehending even a single phenomenon upon thorough searching. One does not apprehend any essence in the eye. One does not apprehend any essence in the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, or the

mind. And one does not apprehend even that all phenomena are without essence. Why? Because the nature of mind is the absence of arising, and that is its very nature. All phenomena are without essence and without object of apprehension — whether past, future, or present, they are not apprehended by the mind. Because they are not apprehended and because no volitional construction is formed, this is therefore called non-construction. And why is it called non-construction? Because neither the old nor the new is volitionally constructed — therefore it is called non-construction. Therein, neither does the past mind find liberation, nor does the future mind find liberation, nor does the present mind find liberation. And because mind is not apprehended, this is called single-pointedness of mind — this is what may be counted as mind.

Kāśyapa, in a future time, monks, nuns, laymen,

laymen and laywomen who are inclined to boastfulness and who posit the destruction of this or that thing will arise. They will perceive things in terms of the five aggregates. When the Tathāgata taught that the five aggregates are like a dream, they will say at that time: "Because there is the convention of calling something 'a dream,' this dream exists — it exists!" And they will present the dream as something genuinely real. "If the dream were nonexistent, then the perception of dream would not arise in us. Therefore that cognition exists, and thus the perception of dream arises in us regarding that dream." In just the same way, they will say that those five aggregates — taught as dream-like because they are grasped — also exist. "For if those aggregates were nonexistent, the Tathāgata would not have described the five aggregates as 'grasped at, and like a dream.'" Those foolish people will generate a perception of the dream as truly real, and upon hearing these very sūtras, they will abandon them.

Among the nuns who arise at that time, some will go to many householders' homes and proclaim that such-and-such a person is not an arhat, and they will speak of obtaining and receiving the nun's pretext, their ground for complaint being twelve matters of wisdom. Among the laymen and laywomen, having heard merely a verse or a portion of a verse, they will proclaim that they have attained realization.

Kāśyapa, at that time, a monk who has striven diligently in a hermitage for twenty or thirty years will associate, for the sake of the Buddha's scriptures, with a layman of just one day's standing, and Kāśyapa, emptiness will be proclaimed. They will come to understand it simply by saying the words

"empty, empty" to one another, and they will speak saying "I have fully realized it." Among the monks who hear such teachings as these and repeat them to one another in this way — when others hear those things, they will become frightened. Whether householder or one who has gone forth, they will say the words: "One should not associate with householders. Rather let one keep away! This is not the Teacher's word." And why is that? For those who know and thoroughly understand in the way described will gather together, and whoever among them speaks of the profoundly deep will be abandoned — because those householders and those who have gone forth will despise that person.

And why is that? Kāśyapa, when the heart of the supreme holy life is taught, even those who understand it will be few. And at that time, even those few will pass into nirvāṇa, and those who uphold the transmissions will be extremely few — and those who are supremely few go without saying.

Kāśyapa, at that time, even within an assembly of a thousand monks, a monk who correctly and without error understands and realizes the truth just as it is will be rare — there will be scarce even one such person there. And the others who arise there will not learn from such a person, for even within an assembly of two thousand monks, a monk who correctly and without error understands and is endowed with the practice of realizing the truth just as it is will be rare — there will be scarce even one such person there.

Kāśyapa, at that time, householders and those who have gone forth will scorn this teaching. Kāśyapa, at that time and in that age, a monk who applies diligent effort to abandoning non-virtuous qualities and cultivating virtuous qualities, who practices yoga without sleeping in the first and last parts of the night — such a monk will at that time be endangered, will be condemned, and will be utterly rejected.

Kāśyapa, it is thus: at that time this Dharma will be utterly destroyed, and the community of monks will be utterly destroyed. At that time, those who are learned and devoted to the profound, devoted to what is unstained, should be treated with reverence, should be honored, and, gathering together as one, should dwell in forest solitudes.

Then the Blessed One at that time declared these verses:

Whatever Dharma I have well taught,
endowed with the meaning of what is supreme —
what teaches the aggregates as having no essence —

regard all of that as like a dream.

At that time those monks
will dispute, be deceitful and unruly.
They will find perceptions of distinction
between what is and is not particular.

Whatever any monk may say,
the others will repeat the very same.
The way of Dharma, they will think, is just that much —
that there is something distinct will not occur to them.

A householder will say to a preaching monk:
"This awakening of the buddhas —
if you truly know it, it is wonderful!
You have obtained the first fruit."

Householders who rely on such monks
think themselves to be seers of the Dharma.
Before such people, gifts upon gifts
will be given again and again.

The monks' preachings are as they are —
in no other way and not otherwise.
"He has seen the truth; therefore what he teaches us
is in accord," the householders think.

There will be giving, yet the monks
will not abide in the sacred Dharma.
Those who arise at such a time
will destroy the awakening of the buddhas.

"Do not rely on that — rely on me.
I am your Teacher.
Just as I myself have become,
so shall you swiftly attain."

"This place is the supreme, the peaceful" —
so they will say to one another.
All assembled together,
they will destroy my teaching.

It is like bandits of extreme ferocity
who plunder and demolish towns —
they lay waste to cities, villages,
and all the surrounding districts.

Likewise, those monks who arise
will be of bad and feeble intellect, utterly deluded,
of little wisdom and broken vows,
relying heavily on a self and on persons.

Because of the deceitfulness I have described,
this Dharma will decline through their influence,
and those same ones will proclaim themselves arhats —
every one of them swollen with superior pride.

Though they gather before the monk-Saṅgha,
it will be a gathering in name only.
Even a single genuine one
will be exceedingly rare.

At that time the awakening
of the Dharma-king will be utterly abandoned.
The gods will be overwhelmed with grief and suffering
and will weep again and again,

Crying out: "The teaching of the Śākya lion,
the supreme Dharma, is utterly destroyed!"
And those gods who have faith
will fall prostrate upon the ground,

Lamenting: "Alas, the Buddha!
Alas, the well-spoken Dharma!
Alas, the Saṅgha, field of generosity —
the sons born from the mind of the Buddha!"
"The Dharma taught by the Dharma-king
will henceforth be heard no more.
All will become darkened in delusion —
this Sage passes beyond sorrow."

The gods of the earth, at that very moment,
will cry out with a great loud voice
so that the gods above may hear:

"This lamp is about to go out!"

"O buddhas — hear this, you who have gone beyond
and who have no peer in the world:
henceforth, let it be that gods and nāgas alike
lay it deeply to heart.

How did you become a buddha?
Through three incalculable eons
you bore all suffering —
your own and that of others.

You who taught the Dharma supremely well
to every sentient being —
the Dharma of that guardian of the world
is now utterly declining.

The troublemakers have arisen,
committing evil of terrible force —
māra's messengers, wrathful māras,
those who would destroy, heedless of counsel and deeply troubled,
deceitful, cunning, and of wicked mind."

Deceitful and childish, base,
they rage and rage against the teacher
and destroy the Victor's teaching.
When that sound rises from the earth below,
the gods of the teacher's realm grow displeased.
The four great kings, too,
will at that time become filled with sorrow.

In the palace of Kubera, lord of yakṣas,
the hosts of yakṣas will have gathered,
all weeping down their faces,
letting out sounds of dreadful fear.
All the gods having assembled,
they lament in utter desolation,
they no longer encourage one another,
and their minds sink into the deepest depression.

Every city so magnificently adorned,
every place where precious things abide,
will lose all fair appearance
and become like heaps of rags.
In those most excellent of cities
there will be no joy in that moment,
in those most excellent of cities
there will be no joy as there was before.

Where I was born,
the gods there will swoon,
and having seen it, they will fall prostrate —
so utterly unbearable will it become.
They will fall to the earth
and lie there, dropping down in that very place,
crying out that the true Dharma
will swiftly come to ruin.

Having descended to Jambudvīpa,
they will witness its complete collapse.
The sons of the buddhas, overcome with grief,
will be utterly devastated.
The supreme cities will for seven days
lose all their splendor and brightness,
and for those seven days the gods too
will weep again and again.

Alas, the great and courageous buddha,
he who was seen face to face —
even that protector has vanished from sight,
even my protector has passed into nirvāṇa.

Those who had come to Śrāvastī
and were receiving hospitality,
abiding in that ground,
will weep again and again:
"This was the seat of a buddha;
here the four noble truths
were taught by the highest of men —
that was something we witnessed directly."

The worlds too will fall into negligence
and will no longer treat one another with respect.
Having committed wicked deeds,
they will proceed to the lower destinies.
The vast mansions of the gods
will at that time stand empty.
The sentient beings of Jambudvīpa
will be without protector and without refuge.
These places that served as promenades
will crumble and stand desolate.

Because the Dharma king has passed into nirvāṇa,
these worlds will have no joy.
Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods
of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three,
will at that time be seized by suffering and bewilderment
and will let out a great cry.
All the gods of the Thirty-Three,
raising their hands, will weep aloud.
Hearing this in the pleasure grove,
they will come running at once,
saying: "He who taught the Dharma,
the protector of the world, is gone" —
so will the gods always and continually
speak in lamentation.

The gods will not eat ambrosia
and will not take up the sound of song.
The gods of the Thirty-Three
will be disconsolate for six months.
Then the asuras, hearing there
that the master of the teaching is no more,
will declare they are going to make war
on the gods of the Thirty-Three.

The kings of Jambudvīpa
will build stūpas for the buddha.
At that time the asuras and the gods
will do battle with each other.
At that time most monks too

will go to the lower destinies.
Most nuns too
will go to the lower destinies.
At that time householders who break the precepts —
lay practitioners or those who dwell at home —
even they, having spoken their words,
will likewise go to the lower destinies.
At that time wicked women too,
their very coming and going will be wicked.
At that time the entire world
will heave and tremble violently.
Some will run to the edges of villages,
some will run to the mountains,
and those beings who scatter and flee
will not be able to preserve their lives for long.

Thieves and robbers will appear in great numbers. Desolate wastelands will spread. Even when grain is planted, it will not take hold, and rats will cause great harm. When famine has arisen, those people whose time of death has come will die and pass into the realm of hungry ghosts, where they will experience suffering. At that time, whatever is offered to the Saṅgha of the four directions and to the stūpas, those monks will divide among themselves. After I have passed away, suffering of this very kind will arise. Therefore strive swiftly and with earnestness, for this is happening right before your eyes. All children are without knowledge, and all children are without wisdom. Those children, having performed their actions, will quickly go to the lower destinies. That from which wisdom arises is the reception of scriptural transmission and delight in recitation. Sentient beings who train in wisdom will quickly go to the higher destinies. When wisdom is properly examined, it is beautiful. Train just as I am, in whatever way that may be. Whoever, having abandoned all assemblies, will quickly attain nirvāṇa. The noble Dharma abides but a short while, so set about it with firm diligence. To that extent one can speak rightly — contemplate it properly and quickly. After this age has passed, for a full sixty eons, when the name of a buddha is not heard, how could joy arise?

Threatened severely by hunger, gathering together from every side, they will eat the flesh of their mothers and the flesh of their children. At that time, even when a son is born, he will not go to his own home with composure, and even

while sitting in his own house he will tremble with extreme terror. Seeing and hearing of such great harm in saṃsāra, who could arise with craving for objects of desire? The root of desire is woman. The root of birth is ignorance. The root of suffering is the aggregates. Therefore abandon suffering utterly.

Sentient beings who are deluded resort to women. Sentient beings who are not deluded will quickly attain the touch of nirvāṇa. There is no karmic maturation for those who misappropriate scriptural transmission, nor is there any meeting with it to come. This — with its defiled fruit, leading to the lower destinies — and those undefiled phenomena that are empty of covering, accumulated, and void, devoid of essence and solitary: understand these quickly.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva who possesses this first Dharma and desires undefiled phenomena should be shown that mind does not rest in any phenomenon whatsoever.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, the bodhisattva should be steadfast in what is to be thoroughly refined. Now, what is the steadfastness in that? What is to be thoroughly refined? It is steadfastness of mind and steadfastness of diligence.

What then is steadfastness of mind? Kāśyapa, in this regard the bodhisattva should think: "Having paid homage to as many buddhas as there are grains of sand in the Ganges River, and having then generated a single thought of awakening, and then further, if there were as many eons as grains of sand in the Ganges, and one buddha arose in each such eon, and by generating the awakening mind as many times as there are grains of sand in the Ganges one were to obtain a single human body, and having obtained human birth as many times as there are grains of sand in the Ganges one were to hear a single word of Dharma and by that wisdom become luminously clear — even so, I should generate the thought that this is of benefit for unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening." This is how the bodhisattva should generate steadfastness of mind.

Therein, the bodhisattva should generate steadfastness of mind in this way: "I will contemplate what the wisdom of a buddha is like. I will seek it out through such great difficulty as this. I will, through such great difficulty as this, truly accomplish that very wisdom of a buddha." Thus should the thought be generated.

Kāśyapa, bodhisattvas are possessed of such steadfastness of mind as this. Now, Kāśyapa, some who lack wisdom will come to understand the meaning

through the explanation of an analogy, so I shall set forth an analogy for you. Kāśyapa, suppose that awakening is to be attained through such a place of extreme difficulty as this: that one should train without breathing out and without breathing in — training without breathing out, without breathing in — for as many aeons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges river; that while dwelling thus for as many aeons as there are grains of sand in the Ganges, one would fully and completely awaken to unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening. Even so, the bodhisattva should generate courage and enthusiasm in regard to that, with the thought: "I will not abandon unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening." Such steadfastness of mind is to be generated. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva is endowed with such steadfastness of mind as this.

Kāśyapa, when a certain bodhisattva generates such a mind, what does he cling to? He clings neither to what is a proper basis nor to what is not a proper basis. How is it that he clings neither to what is a proper basis nor to what is not a proper basis? Because there is no basis that will turn into unsurpassed and perfectly complete awakening, and yet he attains it swiftly.

Kāśyapa, compared to one who fills the great trichiliocosm with precious substances and makes a gift of them, one who dwells in and diligently practises the manner of these sūtras spoken by the Tathāgata — these sūtras that are genuinely inclined toward awakening — will generate a far greater accumulation of merit.

Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva has steadfastness of mind, and steadfastness of mind does not fix upon even the mind itself; therefore it does not become dejected. Now, what are the many things to be purified? The things to be purified are many. What are the many things to be purified? They are those many things of which not even a single arising of mind is able to comprehend. Why is that? Because those phenomena cannot be designated. And this is the supreme thing to be purified here: namely, steadfastness of mind itself.

In this regard, the following is to be said:

"Will it come about, or will it not?

What sort of thing will I become?"

Those who hold the notion of a mind where there is no mind
will encounter great terror.

They constantly think and deliberate,
wondering how awakening is to be attained,

and, settling upon what is not the end of action,
they will give out yoga instructions.

These are the very characteristics of laziness;
these are not the characteristics of awakening.
Here all doubts arise.

If one neither acts upon nor seeks out
a buddha, or even a śrāvaka,
or the supremely excellent phenomena of a buddha,
then by mere sound alone this bliss
cannot be obtained.

Even though the intention and the faith
for accomplishing the great victory are present here,
by mere wishful thought alone this weariness
cannot be obtained.

Here all activities whatsoever
are performed by means of a single Dharma —
having understood this particular point,
one should practise the causes for awakening.

Kāśyapa, when this enumeration of Dharma (paryāya) is taught, one who is
endowed with that enumeration does not even seek to please the buddhas,
yet predicts for oneself: "I myself will become a Tathāgata, an arhat, a
perfectly and fully awakened buddha." In this way one makes a prophecy to
oneself about oneself.

Kāśyapa, what are the trainings a bodhisattva householder should undertake
that will be of benefit for awakening? Kāśyapa, the trainings a bodhisattva
householder should undertake that will be of benefit for awakening are three.
What are the three?

One should be thoroughly devoted to omniscience, one should not fall into
prior conduct, and one should be endowed with the five bases of training.
When one is endowed with those three limbs, one accomplishes six qualities.
What are the six? One attains a noble abiding; one is not foolish or dull like a
sheep; one is not deaf and not mute; one's body becomes manifestly radiant;
one swiftly gains faith and will not be frightened by the profound teachings;
and, without need for effort, through hearing one becomes distinguished and

swiftly attains non-returnership.

There are five qualities that will cut off the arising of those six qualities, and in these one should become skilled. What are the five? One who has committed to not engaging in divisive speech and does not abide in it; one who does not deceive in any way whatsoever; a bodhisattva who perfects intention; miserliness, which will cut off those qualities; and attachment to desires, which will cut off those qualities. These five qualities are what will cut off the arising of those six.

Furthermore, there are three qualities to be taken up and practised. What are the three? One should continuously and without interruption arouse the aspiration to go forth; one should be respectful and deferential toward monks and brahmins (Skt. śramaṇa-brāhmaṇa) who are endowed with moral discipline; and those who teach the Dharma with ulterior motives one should entirely abandon.

Why is this? Because a bodhisattva should not train under them. A bodhisattva should not carry a burden of grass. Why? Because what is accumulated thereby is not the path to awakening, and through not knowing, having been confused, one takes up those qualities in the wrong way and does not train.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a bodhisattva should take up and train in three qualities. What are the three? One should continuously, without interruption, incline toward the buddhas; one should be diligent in reciting what has been received by scriptural transmission; and one should arouse and cultivate a mind of loving-kindness toward all sentient beings. These three qualities one should take up properly and train in.

Furthermore, there are three qualities to be relied upon at all times. What are the three? One should abandon striking with fists and whips; one should not speak disparagingly of others; and one should give fearlessness to sentient beings who are in fear. These three qualities are to be relied upon at all times.

On this it is said:

Do not associate with inferior sentient beings,
nor with those of wrong views.

Upon seeing them, abandon them from afar,
as one would a fierce and venomous snake.

Those who pay homage to such people —
do not follow and train under them.

As when one sees a dog eating carrion,
keep far away from all of them.

Those sentient beings who grasp at objects
go to the lower realms.

Those who follow and train under them —
their destiny is the same.

Having heard the teaching of the Victors
and having no doubt about the teachings of emptiness,
toward whatever monks delight in emptiness
one should show reverence.

From them one's learning increases,
one's wisdom grows sharp,
one draws near to awakening,
and all sentient beings pay homage.

Quickly one performs the restoration ceremony,
quickly one applies what has been received by transmission.
One's wisdom greatly increases,
like a lotus rising from the water.

Quickly one performs the restoration ceremony,
quickly one listens to the Dharma.
One's wisdom greatly expands,
and thereby one severs the defilements.

Great in wisdom and great in diligence,
great in splendour and without fear —
for those who have the wish to act,
who pursue their own highest good:

For a householder, fists —

one abandons blows with fists,
one fully seeks the limbs of awakening,
one does not fall away from the Dharma,
and one's illnesses grow few.

One comes to be endowed with an excellent form,
sentient beings rejoice in one,
one's delight in wealth disappears,

and while dwelling in the household domain
one cultivates the mind of loving-kindness.

Having utterly abandoned all lower destinies,
one goes to the abode of the Thirty-Three Gods.

One obtains the name "god"

and dwells there enjoying what one desires.

Even when one passes away and departs from among the gods,
one does not go to a lower destiny.

Those of noble lineage and good repute
are reborn here in the world of human beings.

One comes to be endowed with fine form,
and none can harm one.

Knowing that "this person practices the Dharma,"
the gods and nāgas guard one.

One comes to see the most excellent of dwelling places,
and all living beings rejoice in one.

One sleeps in ease
and awakens again in ease.

As though protected by the gods,
no fear arises for one.

Such are the characteristics — like these —
that belong to those who possess the vast Dharma
and who dwell in the household state.
Still further, there are very many more.

Whatever virtue a householder who has entered upon awakening
performs for the multitude of beings,
encouraging them and reminding them of what is wholesome,
and granting fearlessness to those who are afraid —
this is not known by the other gods,
but only by the All-Seeing One.

Their path becomes straight,
and all of them come to be endowed with wisdom.

By that root of virtue,
having utterly abandoned all lower destinies,
they are endowed with all three kinds of knowledge

and are trained in the three trainings.

Whatever merit one has made
and whatever homage one has paid —
by that, one has received homage
as if from all sentient beings combined as one.

Whatever merit one has made in paying homage to the Teacher,
and whatever homage one has paid in that way —
by that, one becomes supreme among sentient beings.

For whoever, while dwelling in the household domain,
generates the awakening mind,
these are the qualities of their renown.
Let others too hear them.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva who is a householder should be endowed with three qualities. What are those three? One should abandon auspicious signs and omens; that householder should maintain purity in order to abandon excessive entanglements; and one should be earnestly devoted to extensive learning. One should be endowed with those three qualities.

Furthermore, one should correctly take up and abide in three additional qualities. What are those three? One should not interrupt a Dharma teaching; one should make requests when the Dharma is being spoken; and one should not allow the lamp-flame of sesame-oil butter to be extinguished. One should maintain those three qualities without interruption.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a bodhisattva who is a householder should on no account practice those three qualities that lead to becoming female. What are those three? One should not turn women away from listening to the Dharma; one should not turn them away from looking upon monks; one should not turn one's wife away from looking upon monks. Even with one's own wife, one should not create any obstruction to her hearing the Dharma. One should not lead her in a way that is contrary to the teaching. Having abandoned all that belongs to the nature of the masculine, those three qualities that lead to becoming female should in no way whatsoever be practiced.

Regarding this, it is said:

With firm and devoted faith, again and again
let the sesame-oil butter lamp be kept burning.

From that, one will obtain the tainless eye,
the eye of a buddha.

With that eye, one will, O protector,
come to know all that is to be known.

Whatever is to be known and is not yet known
shall, once knowing what is knowable, come to be known.

The phenomena of what is to be known in the past,
and likewise those arising in the present —
the future need not be examined.

They have come to possess three characteristics, as it were.
Those two characteristics are present.

When those three are entirely abandoned,
all of them become of a single meaning.

By way of characteristic there is no characteristic —
the faculty explained by the buddhas:
that phenomenon is not the faculty.

Whoever examines those things analytically
will not attain the supreme awakening.

When the eye of a buddha has been fully purified,
everything will come to be known through direct perception.

On this very path, rightly and excellently taught,
awakening is to be found.

Those phenomena have not been taught as things,
nor have they been demolished as things.

All phenomena have not been spoken of —
therefore they are said to be "thoroughly explained."

For that reason, the Teacher
teaches the Dharma to householders.

At that time, by means of the sesame-oil butter lamp,
one will come to know through the eye.

When the teaching of the Lion of the Śākyas
is being expounded, let it not be interrupted.

It is to be feared that one will quickly descend to the lower destinies
and swiftly become blind as well.

Again and again, make the request:

"Please teach the teaching of the Victor."

By that wholesome root,

the supreme wheel of Dharma will be turned.

One must not create obstructions,

for having created an obstruction to the Dharma,

one will become a very wretched woman, exceedingly ugly,

hunchbacked and utterly sinful —

seeing no forms whatsoever,

hearing not even the slightest sound,

just as when a living being has been placed

in a dark pit and sits therein.

One who creates obstructions out of jealousy

on account of a spouse,

will swiftly meet death

and be reborn as a woman of extreme sinfulness —

with hair yellow and matted,

black and hideous to behold,

with feet and legs grotesquely deformed, utterly unbearable,

becoming humpbacked and tongueless.

A jealous man who creates such conditions

for the sake of desire

will repeatedly and quickly encounter

these same unbearable states again and again.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are three things a bodhisattva householder must not do. What are those three? First, one must not invite another person to give when they have not been invited to give — and without skillful means one must not give even butter-cream, or anything else whatsoever — and one must not give away what is difficult to give, things that are hard to relinquish entirely. Second, one must not obstruct another's going forth into renunciation, and whether one who has not yet gone forth or one who has already gone forth, one must cause them to rightly take up and maintain the going forth. Third, even if one is appointed as caretaker and overseer of a stūpa containing relics of a Tathāgata, one must not on that basis use its resources and provisions for one's own purposes. These three things a bodhisattva householder must not do.

Regarding this, the following is said:

When giving to another in generosity,
do not give what is not fitting.
All gift-giving that is tainted with fault
must not be given to one who is rare to find.
Go there with faith,
sit with palms joined together,
and again and again, with regard to giving and generosity,
let the mind rejoice fully.
If, in that very place where the Saṅgha resides,
one finds oneself with very little enthusiasm —
from whatever cause a person's enthusiasm has diminished —
make the request, and cause them to take it up.
And the clear, potable drink that is fit to drink,
and whatever others there may be of that kind —
regarding those, do not in your mind
think of causing harm with a contrary attitude.

When a son or else one's own relatives
are undertaking the going forth,
a bodhisattva must not
stand in the way and obstruct them.

May all sentient beings be happy.
May all touch nirvāṇa.
With such an intention as this of mine,
I request that the excellent Dharma be taught.
Knowing these faults and flaws,
let me make myself free of stain.
Having been tainted by mental afflictions,
one grieves for a very long time.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are three things in which a bodhisattva
householder must not exert effort. What are those three? One must not sell
men; one must not sell women; and one must not give others what is not
medicine. And those who do such things — one must not associate with them
either.

On this, the following is to be said:

Selling men must be abandoned.
Selling women must be completely renounced.

One must not give what is not medicine.
Those who do give such things, abandon.
The gods will mock them,
sentient beings will come to experience suffering,
they will wander from region to region and borderland,
and will be harmed by the sting of grief.
By grief in its many forms
they will be harmed for a very long time.
Having fallen into grief, they come to the hour of death.
Therefore, do not do these things.

For this reason, knowing these faults and others as well,
I have spoken of them here only in part
for the sake of bodhisattvas.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are three things a bodhisattva householder must not do. What are those three? One must not go to a prostitute's dwelling; one must not associate with a man or a woman who speaks and acts with a divided mind; and one must not reside in a place where cattle are slaughtered. These three things a bodhisattva householder must not do.

On this, the following is to be said:

Indulging in desire is worthy of reproach.
One must not go to a prostitute's dwelling.
Whoever relies on base desires
will quickly cease to show proper respect.
Those who go to dwell with the beautiful —
those will be censured,
will quickly be struck by illness,
and thereby come to the hour of death.
One who speaks and acts with a divided mind —
whether man or woman — must not be relied upon.
If someone is found to steal another's wife,
bring the full force of your powers to bear on that.
Where cattle are being slaughtered,
in no way whatsoever go there.
I, the Protector, do not praise this
for the sake of pure bodhisattvas.

Because the buddhas know these faults,
they have therefore spoken of them,
and have proclaimed them expressly
for those who engage in what is improper.

Some say: "The buddha's hearers know
wherever our conduct is."

They imagine that before the eyes of the buddhas
their domain of conduct stands revealed.

These things have been taught
for the sake of those sentient beings who dwell in loftiness
and who quickly wish to pass beyond sorrow —
not because the teaching is uncomfortable to hear.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a bodhisattva householder must be endowed with three qualities. What are those three? Dwelling in the home, one must reflect upon one's own life as like a message entrusted to a royal messenger; one must strive to accumulate wealth that is given away and fully released; and regarding whatever has not been given and not released — even if it amounts to a hundred leagues worth — one must not generate the perception that it is one's own; and one must not give rise to the intention of setting it aside for the sake of one's children and spouse. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva householder must be endowed with those three qualities.

On this, the following is to be said:

"I will die soon" —

one must cultivate the perception of death.

Therefore, from the enjoyments one has accumulated,
extract the essence from those enjoyments.

For the sake of children and spouse,
one must not accumulate wealth.

From body, enjoyments, and life,
extract the essence quickly.

Generate intense aspiration for awakening.

Do not be agitated or distracted.

Wealth and Dharma, when abandoned,
will bring harm to the whole body.

This is the play of children —

seeing what appears and seeing what does not appear.

There is no need to taste the flavor.
The momentum of Dharma is the protector.
It must be taught without cease.
This Dharma is forever enduring.
Among those who are peers, mocking one another is suffering.
These Dharma teachings of such a kind
I, Kāśyapa, have fully proclaimed.
All those who will become learned —
I know each one of them.
Knowing that they have understood,
and having become inspired by me,
at that very time, again and again,
I shall become manifest to them.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, if a bodhisattva householder possesses three qualities, he will attain irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. What are these three? He establishes his parents, who lack faith, in faith. He establishes his parents, who lack moral discipline, in moral discipline. He establishes his parents, who are miserly, in generosity. He praises unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening and teaches the Dharma to others as well. This is the first quality by which a bodhisattva householder attains irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, a bodhisattva householder knows who is worthy of honor and who is not worthy of honor. Having discerned those who are worthy of honor and those who are not, he honors those who are worthy of honor, and does not honor those who are not worthy of honor — yet toward those very people he cultivates loving-kindness. Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva householder possesses this second quality, he attains irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, whatever wealth a bodhisattva householder has acquired through suffering and painful effort, he does not squander or waste it. He gives it to no one other than renunciants (śramaṇas) and brahmins who are endowed with moral discipline, and he lives among those who practice the holy life as an equal, without any trace of conceit. Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva householder possesses this third quality, he attains irreversibility from unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Regarding this, it is said in verse:

When a bodhisattva householder
seeks the supreme awakening,
the root of wisdom through which the supreme is realized
arises from these three.

Whatever father and mother there may be
whose minds are dull and lacking in faith,
he rouses in them the will toward faith
and connects them with the supreme Dharma.

To those who are morally degenerate he gives
the union with discipline and wisdom;
to those who lack wisdom he gives wisdom —
and he leads them correctly into the supreme awakening.

Having gone to all four directions
and sought out what has been well taught,
he gives the gift of Dharma —
whatever will cause wisdom to grow.

Having established those of broken discipline in discipline,
having caused those of no faith to take hold of faith,
having caused those of deficient wisdom to grasp wisdom —
such a one will never turn back.

That one of wisdom, seeing a fully ordained monk
who is endowed with discipline and is learned,
pays honor and draws near,
and goes again and again to ask questions.

For the sake of that goal, drawing near to him,
he asks that monk repeatedly.

These qualities belonging to householders —
through them, such a one will swiftly not turn back.

That wise one knows the distinction
in what has been attained by each of the learned,
and knowing the distinctions among the wise,
he would offer even his own flesh to them.

Those things I have declared —
they are the defining mark of faith.
Those who lack faith cannot
bend the awakening mind in that direction.

One who knows the distinctions and is resolute of mind
will swiftly attain the distinctions.
In such a person, all the distinctions among phenomena
will not be scarce.

Having come to know in that way
the distinctions of oneself and others,
one actively realizes mental joy —
and so that one's wisdom grows.

Whatever wealth belongs to such a person,
however it was all accumulated,
he has from the very outset engaged it
in common with those endowed with moral discipline.

He does not speak ill of others,
nor does he speak wrongly.
Possessing generosity and steadfast power,
such a one becomes a Tathāgata.

Excellent in discipline and pleasant to accompany,
a hero who has attained loving-kindness —

Having given a gift, one becomes joyful either beforehand or afterward. The noble lord of giving is a hero — nothing is sought in return from the lord of giving. To every lord of giving who is steadfast, nothing given to him is ever lost. Whether gold or wealth of any kind, what was given in previous lifetimes brings forth the supreme Dharma and its profound excellence, and one seeks to fully obtain the highest rank.

It is not fitting to honor, out of reverence, any single person in a world that includes the gods. One should pay respect to a single individual only for the sake of the meaning of the Dharma. The hero who is born from the Dharma wholly seeks the Dharma of Dharma itself. Cherishing the Dharma and resting one's heart in the Dharma, such a one becomes a guide in the world.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, if a bodhisattva who is a householder possesses three qualities, he turns away from awakening — from the aspiration toward

unsurpassed, perfect, and complete enlightenment — and passes fully into nirvāṇa by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas. What are these three? Kāśyapa, there are some who, having aroused the mind of awakening, become terrified of the hells for sentient beings, and become terrified of the realm of animals and the world of the Lord of Death. They come to perceive awakening as a burden, and if they then fail to keep in mind without interruption the roots of virtue they have genuinely established, fail to take them up, and become mentally weary of them — and if, being mentally weary of them, they come to perceive them as suffering — then, Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva possessing that first quality turns away from awakening and passes fully into nirvāṇa by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are some who, having aroused the mind of awakening, give gifts and yet give those gifts without complete joy; having given, they come to feel regret, and they place no trust in the gnosis of the buddhas. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing that second quality turns away from awakening and swiftly passes fully into nirvāṇa by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are some who, having aroused the mind of awakening, do not exert diligence in seeking to hear much teaching, and by means of those meager roots of virtue they swiftly pass fully into nirvāṇa. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing that third quality turns away from awakening and swiftly passes fully into nirvāṇa by way of the vehicle of the śrāvakas.

Concerning this, it is said:

One who rouses aspiration for awakening
yet does not practice in accordance with it
will turn back from the vehicle of buddhahood
and go instead to the vehicle of the śrāvakas.

Those without faith, those who are lazy,
those who are miserly, those whose wisdom has gone astray —
for these there is no awakening;
these are its very obstructions.

Those who cherish their actions, who uphold discipline,
whose mind delights in giving,
whose heart is fulfilled after having given —
for these, awakening is not far away.

Misdeeds are done with the mind,
and giving too is given with the mind.
Those beings who possess such a supreme mind
become like a stūpa worthy of the world's veneration.

Those who, having abandoned these faults,
have bent their minds toward awakening —
among the worlds, these shall become
unsurpassed fields of offering, buddhas themselves.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva who is a householder possesses three qualities, he turns away from awakening and passes fully into nirvāṇa in the manner of a pratyekabuddha. What are these three? Kāśyapa, there are some who, having aroused the mind of awakening, are miserly with the Dharma. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing that first quality turns away from awakening and passes fully into nirvāṇa in the manner of a pratyekabuddha.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are some among them who, having aroused the mind of awakening, become attached to auspicious signs and omens. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing that second quality turns away from awakening and passes fully into nirvāṇa in the manner of a pratyekabuddha.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, there are some among them who, having aroused the mind of awakening, do not thoroughly seek out the branches of awakening and become lazy. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing that third quality turns away from awakening and passes fully into nirvāṇa in the manner of a pratyekabuddha.

Concerning this, the following is said:

One who is miserly with the Dharma
and does not teach it to others —
though awakening may be gained through favorable conditions,
this person will turn away from awakening.

In this way these two cause harm,
and from harm comes suffering.
Whether to travel onward or to stay nearby —
such a one wavers and doubts about awakening.

Having contemplated the Great Vehicle,
one quickly goes to look at omens.

Those who do not rely on the Teacher here —
these are not the marks of faith.

Those who possess strong aspiration
and seek awakening with steadfastness —
these do not bow to others,
save to the stūpas of the world.

Those of such faith
will not be found by other gods.
For them the supreme is abundantly excellent:
they are called the god of gods.

One who has aroused aspiration for awakening
and does not bow before others —
such a person, in life after life,
will come to be endowed with power and form.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva who is a householder possesses three qualities, his body will become dark — his form will turn black. What are these three? Lighting a butter lamp at a Tathāgata's stūpa, then stealing that butter lamp; displaying anger and hostility toward others when they are generous to someone else; and speaking without being asked, thereby exposing the faults of those who are not wicked. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing these three qualities will become dark in body.

Concerning this, the following is said:

One who lights a butter lamp at a stūpa
and then steals away its light —
that person's body will turn black,
like a crow that is dark.

Without even seeing, one picks out faults,
saying: "I am white and you are black."
When one thus holds another in contempt,
one turns black, like darkness itself.

Keep your speech very well restrained;
there are no actions that go to waste.
Just as an action has been performed,
so too will it return upon the one who did it.

Kāśyapa, if a bodhisattva who is a householder possesses three qualities, he will be reborn in a blacksmith's household. What are these three? Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva who is a householder is himself endowed with the five bases of training, yet when relatives come from a long journey, he offers them alcohol, and moreover invites other sentient beings to drink. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing this first quality will be reborn in a blacksmith's household.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, if a bodhisattva who is a householder is himself celibate, yet engages others in sexual conduct — through the karma created and accumulated thereby, he will be reborn in a blacksmith's household. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing this second quality will be reborn in a blacksmith's household.

Kāśyapa, furthermore, if a bodhisattva who is a householder has undertaken some task of household work, and there is someone engaged with that task in a lawful and proper manner, and he goes to call that person away, saying: "Come here! Stop your recitation for now and take your time over this work" — through the karma created and accumulated thereby, he will be reborn in a blacksmith's household. Kāśyapa, the bodhisattva who is a householder possessing this third quality will be reborn in a blacksmith's household.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Seeing a relative who has arrived,
one summons them to drink,
and gives them an intoxicating draught —
and so one will be born to speak the babble of a blacksmith.

He does not work with needles, weapons, or any craft of that kind. Instead, he sits upon the ground, picks up bellows in his hands, and pumps them. He avoids the company of women, and when others praise his desires, the karmic maturation of all this is that he speaks the babble of a blacksmith. He does not know how to work the bellows with needles or weapons, and taking a hammer in his hands he strikes iron lumps. Because he has abandoned the Dharma, when that person dies and transmigrates, that person will very swiftly be reborn in a blacksmith's household. There he neither sees the bellows nor sees the hammer, yet he smashes every vessel. Such is this karmic maturation.

Kāśyapa, guard your speech. Hold your mind firmly restrained as well. Do not report to others all the phenomena that are non-virtuous. The cycle of birth is suffering, and through craving, rebirth continues to grow. Therefore, practise

the Dharma steadfastly and thoroughly abandon what is not the Dharma.

Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva householder who possesses three qualities will be reborn on a par with the great royal śāla tree — possessed of a beautiful form, fair, pleasant to behold, with a complexion fully perfected and supreme; and he will be free of laziness, clear-minded, and thoroughly resolved. What are the three? Kāśyapa, here a bodhisattva householder who has not previously seen certain renunciants (śramaṇas) and brahmins, upon seeing them thinks: "These are fit recipients of gifts. These are worthy of offerings. These are worthy of being paid homage to. These are a field of merit" — and he arouses joy. With a mind thus filled with joy, he serves them as guests with robes, food, bedding, medicine for the sick, and requisites. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva householder endowed with this first quality will be reborn on a par with the great royal śāla tree. Kāśyapa, moreover, a bodhisattva householder who abides in steadfast earnestness — abiding in that earnestness, he acts exactly as he has spoken and does not speak falsely. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva householder endowed with this second quality will be reborn on a par with the great royal śāla tree. Kāśyapa, moreover, a bodhisattva householder who serves and honours those renunciants and brahmins who are endowed with moral discipline, and draws out their essence. Kāśyapa, a bodhisattva householder endowed with this third quality will be reborn on a par with the great royal śāla tree.

Concerning this, the following is said:

Having seen those who are wise by nature,
endowed with moral discipline, learned, and discerning,
he arouses gladness of heart,
goes to them, and attends to them as guests.

Having attended to them as guests,
he acts rightly in accordance with what he has said.
He does not cut off the stream of his giving,
and he holds no resentment toward them.

For whatever purpose he has served them,
he draws out their essential teaching.
By the distinction of manifold knowledge —
even for something supremely rare, a precious jewel —
those of such faith who have set out toward awakening
move within the domain of wisdom.

For them, attaining awakening holds no difficulty.

Sustained by the highest livelihood,
they gather the most excellent enjoyments,
they seek out what is supreme in the Dharma,
and they touch the highest nirvāṇa.

They will be reborn in the most excellent lineages.
They will attain the most excellent bodily form.
They will bear the most excellent Dharma-robe.
And they will obtain the supreme nirvāṇa.

A wise person, having come to know
such qualities as these, practises them throughout,
and pays respectful homage to the Teacher
who has taught them nearby.

That person travels by the supreme vehicle —
the vehicle of the buddhas.

Nirvāṇa — the reality that is cool —

This is the supreme fruit of that —
whatever kind of action one has done,
its karmic maturation will occur accordingly.
Even across ten billion aeons
it will never be wasted.

Kāśyapa, if a lay bodhisattva is endowed with three qualities, then, while remaining in the householder's life, until the moment of fully awakening to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, he will generate such wholesome roots that he will never indulge in the five strands of sensual pleasure. What are the three? Kāśyapa, here a lay bodhisattva is one who possesses the five bases of training; he does not praise sensual desire to others; and rather than consorting with women, he strives diligently for his own purpose, generating the thought: "Let it suffice for me to enjoy the company of my wife alone — may I not encounter the five strands of sensual pleasure until I have fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening." Kāśyapa, a lay bodhisattva endowed with this first quality will never indulge in the five strands of sensual pleasure until he has fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Kāśyapa, moreover, a lay bodhisattva, upon hearing these sūtra collections such as this one, generates faith, and having generated faith, seeks them out fully. Kāśyapa, moreover, sūtra collections such as these are difficult to grasp and hold — yet he recites them and composes them. Kāśyapa, moreover, whoever hears teachings such as these will entirely dispel all grounds for regret. Through those wholesome roots, he will come to possess the confidence of non-attachment and the confidence of liberation. Whether or not he has passed away and been reborn, he will swiftly behold the Tathāgatas. And if he has passed away and been reborn, he will go to the higher realms of existence, and should not think that unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening is far away. Kāśyapa, a lay bodhisattva endowed with this second quality will never indulge in the five strands of sensual pleasure until he has fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

Kāśyapa, moreover, a lay bodhisattva dedicates all wholesome roots to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. He takes no delight in forms, no delight in sounds, no delight in smells, no delight in tastes, no delight in tactile sensations, no delight in enjoyments, no delight in power, and no delight in retinue. With a mind and karmic maturation that is unconditioned, he swiftly and fully awakens to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening, and until that full awakening he will never indulge in the five strands of sensual pleasure. Kāśyapa, a lay bodhisattva endowed with this third quality will never indulge in the five strands of sensual pleasure until he has fully awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening.

On this, it is said:

The householder keeps well
the five bases of training as his guard.
He abandons consorting with women,
reviling and reproving that conduct.
He seeks out without satiation
teachings such as these.
All grounds for regret,
he swiftly clears away.
All virtuous qualities he dedicates
for the sake of awakening.
Through those wholesome roots,
he swiftly relinquishes sensual pleasures,
and will ever hear the Dharma abundantly.

Having truly aroused compassion,
he teaches the Dharma to sentient beings
and searches everywhere for the path to awakening.
Therefore, upon hearing teachings such as these,
one should give rise to excellent aspiration,
and not be drawn into consorting through desire.
Turn the wheel swiftly.

Then the venerable Mahākāśyapa addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Reverend Blessed One, what is the name of this category of Dharma? How should one uphold it?"

The Blessed One declared: "Kāśyapa, therefore take up this category of Dharma under the name 'The Exposition of the Three Vows.' Take it up also under the name 'A Full Account of the Bodhisattva's Training.' Take it up as well under the name 'The Complete Gathering of All Phenomena.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, the entire retinue with all its members, and the world together with its gods, gandharvas, humans, and asuras rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

This concludes the first chapter, entitled "The Exposition of the Three Vows," from the noble Great Heap of Jewels (Skt. Mahāratnakūṭa), a category of Dharma in one hundred thousand sections.

Translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Surendrabodhi, and by the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshe De; revised in accordance with the new standardized terminology and definitively established.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit title in the first line is given in Tibetan transliteration and has been rendered as reconstructed Sanskrit in standard roman transliteration. The Tibetan text presents it as the phonetic rendering of the original Sanskrit title, and the Tibetan title that follows is a translation of it.

The vast majority of bird and tree names in this passage are Tibetan transliterations of Sanskrit or Prakrit terms for which certain identification is impossible and scholarly consensus is lacking. They have been rendered in approximate phonetic English rather than invented identifications. A few recognizable species have been named where identification is reasonably certain: peacock for rma bya, goose for ngañ pa, crane for khruñ khruñ, vulture for bya rgod, cuckoo for khu byug, and hawk for khra.

The phrase rendered "rhinoceros-faced creatures" and "blue-maned bulls" are attempts at the Tibetan *bse kha sgo* and *ba lañ kha zho sngon po*, which are obscure zoological terms; these identifications are tentative.

The repetition of "dhavaka" appears twice in the Tibetan source text and has been retained as such.

- The phrase rendered "for as long as it takes to milk a cow" translates a standard Indian literary measure of time. The eight qualities of rain-water refer to a canonical list: clear, cool, sweet, light, soft, pure, harmless to the throat, and non-irritating to the stomach; the text names them only by number, so I have left it as "possessing the eight qualities." The term "lebrgan" for one lotus variety is a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit floral term that is not fully transparent; it is left in transliterated form as the underlying Sanskrit is uncertain. The final sentence ends mid-passage as the source text is cut off.
- The name ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ is rendered "Nadī-Kāśyapa" following the standard identification of this figure as Nadīkāśyapa, one of three Kāśyapa brothers; ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ is similarly a river-Kāśyapa epithet and may refer to the same or a related figure. The text lists them as distinct persons, so both are preserved separately. The phrase "ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" throughout functions as a large indefinite plural ("countless," "of a hundred thousand kinds") modifying the classes of beings; it has been rendered contextually as "countless" or "of a hundred thousand kinds" according to the grammatical fit of each clause.
- The list of bodhisattva names throughout this passage is a series of ornate epithets functioning as proper names, many of them compounds whose structure is transparent but whose rendering requires interpretive choice between adjectival and genitive constructions. The renderings given follow the most natural reading of each compound. The term "Navel Essence" for ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་ is literal; it may carry a cosmological sense of "central essence" akin to the world's navel, but no emendation has been made. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, as the list of topknot-bearing bodhisattvas continues beyond the supplied excerpt.
- The repeated listing structure here is a densely enumerated catalogue of bodhisattva names typical of the Avataṃsaka-sūtra tradition, where symmetry and amplification across epithets is a deliberate literary feature rather than a textual problem. The rendering of "ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" as "Foremost Garuḍa" follows the standard identification of this term with the mythic king of birds. The phrase "ཇུ་མཁའ་ལྷ་མོ་" preserves the Sanskrit loanword *sāla* (the *śāla* tree, *Shorea robusta*), sacred in Buddhist tradition as the tree under which the Buddha passed into nirvāṇa.
- The phrase translated as "mother of Rāhu" renders "sgra gcan zin gyi ma" literally as "mother of Rāhu," identifying the nun Grasping Fame by her relationship to Rāhu. In the Indian Buddhist narrative context, this refers to Yaśodharā, who was sometimes called the mother of Rāhula; however, the Tibetan here gives the name of the nun as "Grags 'dzin" (Grasping Fame) and identifies her as "sgra gcan zin gyi ma," so the rendering follows the Tibetan literally without forcing identification with Yaśodharā, which is left for scholarly consideration.

The phrase rendered "cataracts of vision" for "rab rib med pa" uses the classical Tibetan medical and optical metaphor of a cataract obscuring sight; here it signals freedom from any such obscuration of insight — the metaphor is standard in this literature.

- The long chain of causally-linked predicates in this passage is a deliberate rhetorical cascade, each clause generating the next, building an argument that conceptual grasping at "buddha-Dharmas" as objects paradoxically entraps a practitioner in the very proliferation it seeks to transcend. The Tibetan verbs in the chain are terse and philosophically compressed; the renderings here follow the logic of the sequence carefully, though several links (particularly "connects," "fully connects," and "proceeds to complete connection" for *mtsams sbyor ba*,

rnam par mtsams sbyor ba, and yongs su mtsams sbyor ba) reflect a technical progression that may carry more specific Abhidharma resonance than English can easily convey in a single phrase. The term rendered "speaks confusedly" (rnam par smra ba followed by smra ba lkugs pa) is genuinely difficult: the first likely means "speaks at length" or "discourses elaborately," while the second could mean "speaks foolishly" or "speaks like a mute" — a paradoxical image of compulsive yet incoherent speech. This is flagged as a point of genuine interpretive uncertainty.

- The passage contains a sustained wordplay around "མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་" in the context of "མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་" which is deliberately paradoxical: one is called "possessor of the perception of self" precisely because perception itself is never apprehended as an object. The ironic inversion — that the term exists only as a conventional label for a cognitive error — is intentional and has been preserved in the translation.

The phrase "མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་མཐོང་" and related forms carry the sense of staining or smearing space — a classic image for the impossibility of defiling what has no surface to be defiled. The translation renders this faithfully.

The chain at the end of the passage (mental engagement → ego-grasping → activity → intense being → narration) mirrors the opening chain in the preceding passage and is structurally deliberate.

- The final phrase, rendered "go without going," translates a Tibetan expression meaning something like "wander without [true] destination" or "go in a way that is not going." The paradox is intentional and doctrinal: those who do not proceed toward nirvāṇa are in a kind of perpetual, purposeless wandering that does not constitute genuine progress or arrival anywhere — a pointed rhetorical climax to the chain of dependent deterioration.

The passage about the Tathāgata "abiding with a perception of non-accordance regarding phenomena that accord" is intentionally paradoxical. The doctrinal point appears to be that the Tathāgata perceives the ultimate non-reality of what conventionally appears to cohere, and that what sentient beings take to be their "self" is, from the Tathāgata's ultimate perspective, already without substance — hence it is called "the ultimate" in an ironic or apophatic sense.

- The phrase rendered "engage in conduct through auspicious connection" reflects the Tibetan bkra mi shis pa'i sbyor bas sbyor gyis, which is somewhat paradoxical: literally "be joined by an inauspicious joining." The intended meaning appears to be ironic or contrasting — a genuine doctrinal crux. Some editions read this as an exhortation to avoid inauspicious associations, while others read it as a structural contrast setting up the following negatives. The rendering here preserves the surface tension of the passage; commentarial clarification would be needed for certainty.

The phrase "bare grain" for 'bru rjen pa reflects a concrete image of appropriating even unprocessed raw grain — emphasizing grasping at the most basic material possessions as "mine."

- The expression rendered "when the assembly of twenty is not complete" refers to the Vinaya rule requiring a quorum of twenty fully ordained monks to be present for certain formal acts; the text is saying that without such a quorum one does not teach to a women's assembly, but an exception applies when one is in a setting among men.

The phrase translated "loose women" renders a term that literally means something like "a woman of the borderlands" or a wandering or unchaste woman; the precise social category is uncertain, but the context groups her with prostitutes and young girls as persons whose company a monk should avoid.

The instruction about covering one's face with both hands when a nun prostrates is an unusual and striking Vinaya-related injunction; it is rendered literally as the text presents it, reflecting a posture of deliberate non-engagement.

- The phrase rendered "communicate their intentions by pursing their lips" translates a Tibetan expression for a gestural or facial signal of desire — the precise nuance is slightly compressed in translation but the erotic implication is clear in context. The passage is a prophetic warning about degeneracy in the Saṅgha in the future age, attributed to the Buddha speaking to Kāśyapa, and the twenty behaviors are being enumerated though only four are listed before the passage breaks off; the remainder presumably follow in the next section.

- The phrase rendered "intimate friends and sisters of the ink-brush" translates a term suggesting a close affective bond signaled by a specific gesture or written token; the exact nuance of the Tibetan compound is somewhat compressed, but the sense of feigned spiritual kinship used to mask romantic intent is clear from context.

The phrase "place of mere signs and marks" renders a technical expression indicating that only the outward appearances of the Dharma will remain, with no inner substance — a standard formulation in degeneracy-of-the-age prophecies.

The final sentence is incomplete as the passage breaks off mid-thought; it has been translated up to the point of the break.

- The phrase rendered "those who dwell in improper situations and abide in what is improper will teach the Dharma to others" reflects a compressed Tibetan construction indicating that these monks, themselves residing in inappropriate circumstances, nonetheless presume to instruct others — the irony being intentional.

The passage "recognizing all sentient beings as having been related to one as mother and father in former lives" renders a stock phrase in Tibetan Buddhist moral teaching; the Tibetan literally says "as kin in the scope of former ink," which is a standard formulaic expression for the idea that all beings have at some point been one's parents.

- The phrase rendered "patience with respect to the non-inherent-existence of all phenomena" translates *chos thams cad la dngos po med pa'i bzod pa*, which corresponds to the Mahāyāna technical concept of the forbearance or patient acceptance (*kṣānti*) of the non-arising or essencelessness of all dharmas — related to the Sanskrit *anupattikadharmakṣānti*. This is a significant doctrinal term and the rendering attempts to capture both its technical sense and its readability in the flow of the passage.

The closing line — "they will come to give up great generosity entirely" — renders *sbyin pa chen po yongs su gtong bar 'gyur*. The verb *yongs su gtong ba* can mean either "to give up / relinquish" or "to give away fully / bestow." In context, where this is described as an antidote (*gnyen po*) for those who are few, scorned, and struggling, "bestowing great generosity" is arguably the intended sense — that practicing great giving will serve as their counterforce. The ambiguity is real and consequential.

- The closing line is an incomplete sentence in the Tibetan, ending mid-question. This appears to be a deliberate break at the end of the supplied passage; the argument continues beyond what has been given here. The text has been rendered faithfully up to the point of truncation.

The phrase rendered "with you as the reference point" translates a grammatically compressed construction in which the Buddha distinguishes between addressing Kāśyapa directly and making a general doctrinal statement using Kāśyapa as the illustrative case; the exact pragmatic force is slightly ambiguous, but this reading follows the most natural doctrinal context.

- The phrase rendered as "clothed in the robe of Dharma" reflects the Tibetan "*chos gos kyis*

dkris pa," literally "wrapped in the robe of Dharma," meaning they wear the monastic robe outwardly but are inwardly unqualified — a pointed irony the text intends.

The passage on "the running of a fox" is a sustained simile comparing morally degenerate future monks to a fox's flight from a dog; the several sub-applications that follow each elaborate a specific behavior. The text breaks off mid-simile ("the fox runs into a hole"), indicating the passage continues.

- The two hell-realms named here — the forest of sword-blades and the forest of bright trees — are standard Abhidharma hell-subsidary regions. The Tibetan "gsalśing gi tshal" literally means "forest of bright or shining trees," corresponding to the classical śālmālī or śīmśapā iron-tree hell, where the trees bear sword-like leaves or thorns; the precise Sanskrit correlate here is the śālmali-vana or asi-patravana. The distinction between the two names is preserved faithfully.

The passage's central dialectical exchange on designation and emptiness is a standard Madhyamaka refutation technique: the interlocutor who denies that "Tathāgata" is a designation is shown to be caught between two equally untenable positions — either emptiness (which cannot be spoken) or mere designation (which would make any named thing a buddha). The translation preserves this structure without smoothing it.

- The phrase rendered "nihilistic speech, denial of things, denial of the aggregates, and denial of ritual observances" reflects a Tibetan list that reads as four items but the text introduces them as "three." This is almost certainly a textual irregularity in the Tibetan itself, where "nihilistic speech" (chad par smra) may function as a heading and the three following phrases as its elaborations, or there has been a scribal error in enumeration. The translation preserves the Tibetan as it stands without emendation.

The verb "grasp at" in the long list of sentient beings who "do not grasp at a higher realm" and so forth is somewhat ambiguous in context; the Tibetan verb 'dzin pa here likely means "to claim the status of" or "to aspire to," and the list illustrates beings who observe none of the ethical or religious norms of their world.

- The phrase rendered "four pairs of persons and eight individual persons" refers to the classical Abhidharma schema of the four stages of attainment (stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner, arhat), each with a person on the path to that stage and one who has attained it, yielding four pairs and eight individuals. This is a standard technical formula in śrāvaka soteriology.

The phrase "ninety-one thousand aeons passed in emptiness" most likely means those aeons passed without a buddha appearing, i.e., they were "empty" of buddhas — a recognized usage in this type of cosmological narrative.

The final sentence is left deliberately open, as the Tibetan passage ends mid-sentence and the continuation is evidently in the next passage.

- The phrase rendered "wandering merchant who has roots and bonds" translates a simile comparing the person to a merchant who is both deeply rooted (in bad habits or attachments) and bound (by ties that make later regret inevitable). The exact referent of the Tibetan compound is compressed; the general sense is of someone who, due to entrenched attachments, inevitably comes to grief and regret, like a poorly prepared traveler.

The final verse "those monks who speak of emptiness and do not rely on the person — they generate hatred toward emptiness" is an important doctrinal passage warning against a misunderstanding of emptiness that slides into nihilism and rejection of conventional personhood; the Tibetan is clear, though the doctrinal irony (that misusing "emptiness" leads to lower rebirths) is intentional and pointed.

- The phrase rendered "those born from my heart, my sons" reflects the Tibetan "nga'i sras

thugs las skyes pa," literally "my sons born from the mind or heart," a standard honorific for those monks most intimately connected to the Buddha's transmission.

The line "where the world of Brahmā was reached" refers to the journey to Vārāṇasī and Sarnath, where the Buddha first turned the wheel of Dharma, said to have been requested by Brahmā.

The passage "the rule was established: no one shall rise" likely refers to the Vinaya rule that monks need not rise for an approaching visitor under certain circumstances; this rule is traditionally traced to an episode during the Buddha's visit to the group of five ascetics at Sarnath, and the awkwardness of their resolving not to welcome him yet being compelled by his presence to do so.

- The line rendered "those who, by means of hoarding-dharmas, speak of this place among others — they are great fierce robbers, and all sentient beings should bow before them" is doctrinally and syntactically unusual. The Tibetan contrasts two categories: those who "dwell in this place" with hoarding-dharmas (ལྷོན་པ་ལྷོན་པ་), apparently referring to accumulating material goods under the guise of Dharma, are called great fierce thieves; against these, the phrase "all sentient beings bowed" may be ironic or the reference may be reversed. The passage may intend that the virtuous practitioners described just before are worthy of reverence, while those who hoard are condemned. The syntax is compressed and the exact referent of each pronoun is not wholly certain.

The final stanza is also compressed: "monks who will be cast out by their form alone" likely refers to those who wear the external form of monks but lack genuine ordination or conduct, whom the Teacher foresaw would corrupt the Saṅgha in the future age.

- The phrase rendered "basket-like Dharma" translates a Tibetan term that most likely refers to activities or practices that are merely outward containers — the image of a basket suggesting something that holds things but is insubstantial or hollow. Some editions may differ on this precise image, and it could alternatively refer to specific categories of Vinaya procedure, but the contextual sense of hollow or superficial religious performance is clear. The phrase "placed in a position of a vessel for things such as food" reflects the Tibetan idiom of treating oneself as merely a receptacle for provisions through covetousness. The phrase "monks of the sūtra-school who dwell on the foundation of intention" is a somewhat compressed expression; the Tibetan points to monks oriented toward the spirit rather than the letter of the teaching, in contrast to the corrupt monks described.

- The phrase rendered "do not be acquainted with having no refuge" translates a grammatically compressed instruction about avoiding the condition of homelessness or placelessness; the exact nuance may be that the monk should not become so without a proper dwelling that he falls into idleness, but the Tibetan is terse and the precise sense is debated.

The name "Bhadrakṣema" (Tibetan: བླ་མ་ལྷོན་པ་) is the monk's name reconstructed from the Tibetan elements meaning "one who preserves the good." The episode referred to appears to be a known incident in which this monk defied a training rule instituted by the Buddha, though the specific canonical parallel is not certain.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text as provided; the translation faithfully reproduces this incompleteness.

- The phrase rendered "rooted in the means of livelihood restrained" translates ལྷོན་པ་ལྷོན་པ་ལྷོན་པ་, literally "rooted in restraint of requisites or provisions." The compound is slightly elliptical; the sense is that the practitioner's material supports are kept under strict restraint, consistent with the preceding passage's theme of monks clinging to provisions.

The list of "roots" of armor presents a structural challenge: the Tibetan runs them as a single compounded list without explicit syntactic breaks between them, and the rendering attempts to preserve that cumulative rhetorical force.

- The simile of the drum is unusual and the Tibetan syntax is compressed. The drum is described with several participial phrases that are somewhat ambiguous in application — it is not entirely clear whether each attribute describes the drum itself or the person bearing it. The rendering here follows the most natural reading of the drum as the referent, with the moral pointing to the Tathāgata's gift being "nothing graspable" and therefore not something to be carried off as a possession. This is a doctrinal point about non-grasping even of the Dharma itself.

The monk names — Kokālika, Devadatta, Khaṇḍadravya-Bya, Katamorakatiśya, Sāgaradatta, Aśvajit, Nābhaso, and Suvarṇākṣa — are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic renderings; minor discrepancies with canonical Sanskrit forms are possible.

- The first simile mentions a creature rendered here as "a wool-bearing bull, a great elephant" from a "crow's nest." The Tibetan reads "bya ka la ku ṭi ka" which is a transliteration of Sanskrit kālakaṭika or similar; and "bal glang" meaning a wool-bearing ox and "glang po che" meaning elephant — these appear to be combined into a single impossible creature, perhaps a yak-elephant hybrid, underscoring the absurdity. The rendering reflects the composite nature of the Tibetan.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation preserves that break faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "those who speak of sentient beings down to those who speak of nirvāṇa" picks up the analogical sequence begun in the preceding passage, referring to people who define themselves or reality in terms ranging from sentient-being identity all the way up to nirvāṇa — a spectrum of philosophical self-descriptions. The Tibetan is compressed here and continues the syntax of the simile of the man who has never seen the king.

The phrase "they give together with their own persons" renders the idiom of dedicating oneself bodily along with family and possessions, a classical way of expressing complete generosity.

"Abandoning their own individual liberation" renders so so thar pa bor te, literally "casting off their own prātimokṣa," referring to their monastic or personal liberation vow — a pointed critique of monastics who neglect their vows while involved in lay households.

- The verse "One who for a hundred eons and more / gave away hands and feet entirely..." appears to invoke the bodhisattva's own past practice of giving, used rhetorically to underscore how far these monks have fallen from the ideal — they show no regard even for a buddha who performed such sacrifices.

The phrase rendered "dark, grinning faces" (thams cad ngo 'dzum gnag gyur) is somewhat unusual; "ngo 'dzum gnag" likely means their faces are dark and set in a false smile or grimace, conveying hypocrisy rather than genuine joy. This reading is contextually supported.

The lines "Having renounced the notion of poverty regarding oneself / and constantly abandoned the self-perception" are condensed and slightly cryptic in the Tibetan; they appear to mean: having given up the self-referential sense of lack and the fixed notion of self, one can generate true yoga practice. The doctrinal point is that genuine practice requires relinquishing ego-based attitudes.

- The closing colophon identifies this as the third and final fascicle of a sūtra chapter titled "The Teaching on the Three Vows" belonging to the Mahāyāna. The transition into the new section at the very end begins a fresh dialogue that the following passage will continue.

The phrase rendered "those of learning will become few" translates a line where the Tibetan "monks of learning" or "those with learning" become scarce — the syntax is slightly compressed and could alternatively be read as "a monk's learning will diminish," but the former reading fits the context of the Dharma's decline more naturally.

- The passage on "falling from a cliff" is an unusual simile. The point appears to be that just as a person plummeting into a void ceases to breathe — i.e., dies — so too fixating on things through signs and characteristics spiritually destroys the practitioner. The cliff-fall analogy is read here as illustrative of fatal grasping rather than of liberation.

The sequence of "corpse-contemplation" perceptions (skeleton, eaten away, livid, reddened, infested with worms, dissolved) maps onto the classical meditation on the loathsome aspects of the body; they are listed here as examples of conceit because even such meditative perceptions, if reified, become objects of pride.

The sentence ends mid-thought with "and not the quality that makes one a brahmin" — the Tibetan itself breaks off here, suggesting the passage continues in the next section.

- The phrase "gnas gsum" rendered as "the three loci" refers contextually to the three times — past, present, and future — as objects of meditative striving; this reading is confirmed by the subsequent passage equating the "three loci" with those same three temporal modes. Some editions may read this passage with the "three realms" sense of dhātu, but the temporal interpretation is strongly supported by the immediate context.

The expression "rje gcig pa" rendered "single-pointedness of mind" follows the standard rendering of cittaikāgratā, the technical meditative term; the passage's own definition subverts the conventional meaning by identifying it with non-apprehension rather than concentration on an object, which is the doctrinal point the text is making.

- The passage about the nun's pretext being "twelve matters of wisdom" renders a compressed and somewhat obscure Tibetan phrase. The term translated as "twelve matters of wisdom" refers to the formal Vinaya category of the nun's "base case" or grounds for complaint, which in certain traditions involves twelve items; the exact referent may vary by Vinaya recension, but the general sense — that nuns will falsely claim attainments using formal procedural grounds as cover — is clear from context.

- The phrase rendered "those devoted to what is unstained" translates a term that literally means "devoted to what is unsoiled or untainted" — the sense is devotion to teachings free from defilement, and the rendering captures the doctrinal nuance without awkwardness.

The line "sons born from the mind of the Buddha" renders a compound meaning "sons arisen from the mind-heart of the Awakened One," a recognized epithet for bodhisattvas or, in context, the noble Saṅgha.

The final verse describing the māras contains a compact list of attributes applied either to the troublemakers or to the māras themselves; the syntax is elliptical in the Tibetan, and the translation follows the most natural reading treating these as further characterizations of those beings.

- The phrase rendered "the palace of Kubera" translates a term meaning "the palace with the willow trees," which is a standard epithet of the palace of Vaiśravaṇa (Kubera), the great yakṣa lord and one of the four great kings; the connection to Kubera is conventional in this context.

The phrase rendered "the gods of the teacher's realm" (bla ma'i lha) is slightly ambiguous; it could mean "the gods who are the superiors" in a general hierarchical sense, but in context it most naturally refers to the higher gods associated with the Teacher, i.e., the buddha's divine protectors or the gods of higher realms.

- The passage about "covering, accumulated, and void, devoid of essence and solitary" renders

a compressed cluster of terms for the undefiled: empty of overlay, accumulated yet insubstantial, hollow, without core, and secluded. These five or six epithets for the undefiled dharmas are a standard enumeration in Āgama-style sūtra literature; the rendering is necessarily approximate since the Tibetan itself is condensed.

The phrase rendered "misappropriate scriptural transmission" translates "lung 'bogs byed," literally "to pilfer or siphon off scripture," meaning to claim or exploit transmission improperly; this is a genuine interpretive choice.

- The verse line rendered "this weariness cannot be obtained" translates a construction that is somewhat paradoxical in the Tibetan: "བྱུང་པར་མཁོ་སྐྱོན་ལྡན་པའི་ཕྱིན་ཆོར་གྲུ་ལྟོག་པའི་ཀློང་།" where "བྱུང་པར་མཁོ་" (weariness, hardship, toil) is likely being used ironically or in a transferred sense — meaning the fruits of that arduous effort cannot be reached by wishful thinking alone. The translation preserves the surface reading while the doctrinal point is clear from context.

The phrase "what is not the end of action" for "何事の終りなる事" is a genuinely difficult expression; it may mean settling upon incidental or secondary practices rather than the definitive culmination of practice. The rendering is approximate.

- The final verse and the line "For a householder, fists" are the opening of a new verse stanza that breaks off at the passage boundary. The line reads literally "In this, a householder, with fists," indicating the start of a new topic about household conduct, left incomplete by the passage cut.

The phrase rendered "carry a burden of grass" is a well-attested Tibetan idiom for accumulating spiritually worthless material, and the teaching here is that what is gathered from ill-motivated teachers amounts to nothing but such a burden.

The instruction to "not fall into prior conduct" refers to abandoning previously held, spiritually harmful habits of one's lay life, a standard meaning in this context.

- The verse at the end presents interpretive difficulty. The final four lines deal with temporal divisions of knowable phenomena and a distinction between "three characteristics" and "two characteristics." This appears to be a condensed doctrinal statement likely referring to the three times and possibly to two of the three marks of existence or two aspects of knowledge. The phrasing "as it were" renders what is grammatically an approximative particle, signaling that the enumeration is tentative or analogical. This is a genuinely obscure passage and a fuller commentarial context would be needed to render it with greater confidence.

The phrase rendered "sesame-oil butter lamp" translates a compound referring to a lamp fed with the oil expressed from sesame or grain — a standard offering lamp. The connection between keeping the Dharma lamp lit and obtaining the buddha-eye is a well-attested metaphor in sūtra literature.

The section on not causing women to become female — that is, on not through one's actions generating karmic conditions that cause beings to take female rebirth — reflects a doctrinal context in which rebirth as a woman was considered karmically unfavorable in certain Mahāyāna sūtra passages. This should be understood within its historical and doctrinal context.

- The verse passage in the opening section is syntactically compressed and philosophically dense, touching on Madhyamaka-style reasoning about characteristics and the nature of phenomena. The line "by way of characteristic there is no characteristic — the faculty explained by the buddhas: that phenomenon is not the faculty" reflects a standard argument that no dharma can be established by its own intrinsic defining mark, and that what is called a "faculty" by buddhas is not ultimately a faculty in any fixed sense. This is a genuine doctrinal crux and the rendering follows the most natural Madhyamaka reading.

The phrase rendered "butter-cream" translates *mar gyi snying khu*, literally "the essence or heart of butter," a rich dairy product; this is likely a synecdoche for valuable or precious goods rather than a narrow dietary reference.

The line about "giving to one who is rare to find" translates *skye bo dkon la sbyin mi bya*, which could mean either "do not give to one who is rare" or "do not give what is faulty to one who is rare and precious." The latter reading is adopted here as contextually more coherent.

- The phrase rendered "speaks and acts with a divided mind" translates the Tibetan "smra sems tha dad par spyod pa," which literally means "speaking and acting with divergent or different mind" — implying someone whose words and intentions are at odds, or who is duplicitous in speech and conduct. The doctrinal point is association with those of deceitful or hypocritical character.

The line "bring the full force of your powers to bear on that" renders a phrase that could alternatively mean "report it diligently" or "exert oneself in confronting it." The precise sense is somewhat ambiguous; the meaning seems to be that one should actively oppose the misconduct rather than ignore it.

The closing verses, from "I know each one of them" onward, likely carry a devotional and aspirational sense: the speaker (here the Buddha or the bodhisattva-protagonist) vows to manifest as a guide to those future practitioners who come to understand these teachings. The repetition "again and again, I shall become manifest" echoes the *nirmāṇakāya* doctrine of skillful manifestation for the benefit of beings.

- The verse section ends mid-stanza at the close of the passage, with the last two lines introducing further qualities. This is a continuity break in the source, not a translation choice.

The phrase rendered as "without any trace of conceit" translates "sri ba med par spyod do," which literally means "living without arrogance" or "conducting oneself without pride." The precise nuance of sri ba med pa in this context may carry the sense of non-competitiveness or humility in conduct among practitioners of the holy life; this rendering captures the most contextually plausible meaning.

- The phrase rendered "the Dharma of Dharma itself" translates the compressed Tibetan "chos kyi chos," which likely means the ultimate or inner nature of the Dharma — a genuine doctrinal subtlety preserved deliberately rather than smoothed over.

The phrase "fields of offering" renders *sbyin gnas*, literally "bases or loci of giving," a technical term for those worthy of receiving offerings; in context it anticipates buddhahood as the supreme such locus.

- The phrase rendered "speak the babble of a blacksmith" translates "བཞག་གི་སྐད་རྒྱུ་བོད་ཀྱི་སྤྲེང་བའི་སྐད་" and refers to the inarticulate or rough speech associated with blacksmiths, understood in the Indian social context as a low-caste vocation. The verse ends here mid-stanza in the Tibetan as given; the passage appears to continue beyond what has been supplied.

The term "འཁྱུག་པ་" rendered as "omens" or "auspicious signs and omens" together with "འཁྱུག་པ་ལྟ་བུ་" refers to favorable signs and portents — a common pairing in Tibetan indicating attachment to external omens as substitutes for genuine practice. This is a recognized fault in the householder bodhisattva.

- The verse "Nirvāṇa — the reality that is cool" ends the passage mid-sentence in the source; the Tibetan appears to be incomplete here, cutting off at what is likely the conclusion of a verse line. No completion has been supplied.

The phrase rendered "abides in steadfast earnestness" translates *yi dam snying po can la gnas pa*, literally "abides in what is heartfelt and earnest in commitment." The term *yi dam* here does not refer to the tantric meditation deity (*yidam*) but to a pledge or commitment held at heart; the rendering reflects this non-tantric sense.

The "great royal śāla tree" is a simile for nobility, beauty, and excellence, the śāla (*Shorea robusta*) being among the most magnificent trees of the Indian subcontinent and associated with the Buddha's final passing.

- The phrase rendered "with a mind and karmic maturation that is unconditioned" reflects the Tibetan "'dus ma byas kyi sems dang 'dus ma byas kyi rnam par smin par gyur nas," literally "having become possessed of an unconditioned mind and an unconditioned maturation." This is a somewhat unusual formulation; the sense appears to be that the bodhisattva's mind and its karmic fruition are no longer shaped by compounded, sense-oriented conditioning — a positive doctrinal assertion that his resolve and its results are, as it were, free from the pull of conditioned existence. The precise technical import may vary by commentarial tradition.

The address "Kāśyapa" renders the Tibetan "Ösung" which is a translation of the Sanskrit Kāśyapa (specifically in this context Mahākāśyapa or, in some texts of this genre, the interlocutor Kāśyapa). The Tibetan literally means "Light-Protector."

• The colophon names three figures: Jinamitra and Surendrabodhi as the Indian paṇḍitas, and Yeshe De as the Tibetan lo tsā ba and chief editor. The phrase rendered "great editor-translator" reflects the honorific title "zhu chen gyi lo tsā ba," indicating Yeshe De's senior editorial role in the imperial translation bureau. The title of the larger collection, འཕེལ་བཤམས་པུ་མཁའ་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཁའ་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཁའ་མཆོད་, corresponds to the Sanskrit Mahāratnakūṭa-sūtra, a major anthology of Mahāyāna sūtras. The phrase "one hundred thousand sections" renders འཕེལ་བཤམས་པུ་མཁའ་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཁའ་མཆོད་ཀྱི་མཁའ་མཆོད་ literally; this is a formulaic designation for the collection's scope rather than a precise count.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.